HP40 and hpd: Profiling, Data-Mining and Rebuilding an Integer-Exact Context Mixer for General-Purpose Compression

Odin Loch (with Claude Code)

2026-11-05 · hpd 1.2.0

Code, data and scripts: https://github.com/odin-loki/HPv40-Compression-Algorithm · **Source package:** `hpd-1.2.0-src.zip` (§18) · **Status:** Research report in two parts. All numbers are measured in this study unless cited to the upstream lab log.

Abstract

HP40 is champion v40 of the `hp` Hutter-Prize lab (odin-loki/CompressionAlgorithm): an integer-exact, bitwise context-mixing (CM) compressor whose 75 experts and 39 accepted compile switches were all tuned on Wikipedia XML. We rebuild it byte-exactly (1,721,462 bytes on the first 8 MiB of enwik8, matching the lab log) and ask whether it is a good **general-purpose** compressor.

On a 27 MB, 42-file mix of the Calgary, Canterbury, Silesia (first MiB of each file) and enwik8 corpora, HP40 at its tuned setting writes **6,256,158 bytes (1.851 bits/byte): 20.1% smaller than xz -9e and brotli-11**, and HP40 or Lite writes the smallest archive on 39 of 41 distinct files. The exceptions are a fax bitmap, where xz wins by 5.4%, and one 13 KB English paper, where brotli's dictionary wins by 21 bytes. Its cost is the problem. At `--mem 22` it codes at **8 KiB/s in both directions** and commits **10.6 GiB** of RAM to every file, including a 3.7 KB one. Profiling shows it is memory-latency bound: 95% of context-model time is one random table load per model per bit. Two word tables with 2^{31} slots each hold 73% of its memory, and on this VM the table zeroing alone costs 17–36 s per file.

Mining every expert's prediction on every bit of 18 data types shows that mixing beats the best single expert by 6–72% (median 27%). The 75 expert logits have an effective rank of only 1.6–7.2. Plain order-1…6 models and an online context-discovery pool win 76% of all bits. Seven Wikipedia-specific families win under 1% each.

Leave-one-out and add-back ablations on a separate tuning set yield **HP40-Lite**, which keeps **43 of the 75 experts**. It drops ten near-redundant families and shrinks the discovery pool from 12 to 4 slots. Lite is **1.21% larger** than HP40 (6,332,030 bytes, still 19.1% below xz -9e), and takes **44–52% less time with about 40% less memory**. It dominates HP40 at every table size below the largest: Lite at `--mem 22` is smaller and faster than HP40 at `--mem 18`.

Shrinking the tables is the bigger lever. At `--mem 16` (195 MiB) HP40 still beats xz -9e by 17.3%. We give six engineering changes, all aimed at layout, allocation and data-type gating rather than new models. The upstream lab independently adopted three of them after v40.

Part II applies these findings. **hpd** is HP40-Lite rebuilt around the profile: cache-line buckets with checksums, demand-zero tables, a record model, an x86 transform, pass-through of incompressible data and parallel blocks. It is **1.55% smaller than HP40, 5.6× faster and uses 1/18 of its memory**, writing **1.823 bits/byte on the GP set (21.3% below xz -9e)** and 1.474 bits/byte on the full 212 MB Silesia corpus (19.4% below xz -9e), the smallest archive of every tested compressor on 40 of 41 GP files and all 12 Silesia files. A GPU build writes byte-identical archives, but on an RTX 3090 it only reaches 0.84–0.95× the speed of a 64-thread CPU, and the small shards it needs cost 27–45% in ratio.

Headline numbers for HP40 and HP40-Lite (GP set, 27,033,797 bytes):

system	bytes	bits/byte	vs xz -9e	compress speed*	peak RSS
HP40, `--mem 22`	6,256,158	1.851	−20.1%	8.3 KiB/s	10.6 GiB
HP40-Lite, `--mem 22`	6,332,030	1.874	−19.1%	18.1 KiB/s	6.2 GiB
HP40, `--mem 18`	6,348,580	1.879	−18.9%	14.7 KiB/s	704 MiB

system	bytes	bits/byte	vs xz -9e	compress speed*	peak RSS
HP40-Lite, `--mem 18`	6,440,845	1.906	−17.7%	25.1 KiB/s	418 MiB
xz -9e	7,827,736	2.316	0	1,127 KiB/s	138 MiB
brotli -q11 -w24	7,835,477	2.319	+0.1%	344 KiB/s	111 MiB

*Whole-set wall time including start-up; HP runs shared the 4-core VM (§4.2). Single-job timings are in Table 3.

Contents

Part I — HP40 and HP40-Lite as general-purpose compressors. 1. Introduction · 2. The systems under test · 3. Method · 4. Results · 5. Profiling · 6. Data-mining the experts · 7. Designing HP40-Lite from the data · 8. Discussion · 9. Conclusion

Part II — hpd: turning HP40 into a day-to-day compressor. 10. Method · 11. Speed: removing the DRAM wait · 12. Memory and start-up · 13. Ratio: models for data HP40 never saw · 14. Results on the GP set (42 files, single thread) · 15. Full Silesia, 4 threads · 16. Portability · 17. What is still weak · 18. Source code · 19. On the GPU · 20. Conclusion

Appendices. A. Reproducing Part I · B. Per-file archive bytes

Part I — HP40 and HP40-Lite as General-Purpose Compressors

1. Introduction

`hp` is an integer-exact context-mixing compressor written for the Hutter Prize: every model, gate and size in it was accepted or rejected by its effect on Wikipedia XML (enwik8). Its champion **v40** (HP40) reached 1,721,462 bytes on the first 8 MiB of enwik8, 25% smaller than xz -9e. A later descendant (v78, "gate24") is vendored into Cypha as CyphaLM's byte predictor (`native/third_party/hp`).

This paper asks a different question: **is HP40 a good general-purpose compressor?** General-purpose means three things a Hutter-Prize score does not measure:

1. **Ratio on data it was not tuned on**: executables, databases, images, spreadsheets, PDFs, tarballs and small files, not just Wikipedia.
2. **Cost**: time, memory and start-up for real file sizes, and how those scale with the `--mem` table-size knob.
3. **Efficiency of the model set**: how many of its 75 experts earn their keep on general data, and what a lighter variant, **HP40-Lite** (fewer experts), gives up.

We answer by reproducing HP40 byte-exactly from the upstream lab, running it and Lite against seven standard compressors on 42 files (27 MB) from four corpora at four table sizes, profiling it at the function, instruction and memory level, and **mining** its experts: we log every expert's prediction on every coded bit of 18 data types to see which experts win, how redundant they are, and where the mixing gain comes from. The expert set for Lite is chosen from leave-one-out and add-back ablations on a separate tuning set, not by hand.

Contributions

- A byte-exact rebuild of HP40 from the lab log (39 compile switches and a table-size cap over the v47-era tree), with the recipe and a five-switch patch that makes every expert family removable (`data/v40_flags.txt`, `patches/hp40_lite_switches.patch`).
- The first general-purpose evaluation of HP40: 16 configurations × 42 files, every archive size, time and peak RSS recorded (`data/*.jsonl`).
- A CPU and memory profile that locates the bottleneck (one random DRAM load per context model per bit) and the memory (two 4 GiB word tables), with an analytic memory model that matches measured RSS within 4%.
- An expert-level data-mining study over 18 data types: standalone costs, win shares, correlation spectra, mixing gains, bit-position costs and learning curves.
- **HP40-Lite**, 43 of 75 experts, chosen by measured ablation: 1.2% larger than HP40, 44–52% less time, about 40% less memory.
- Concrete engineering recommendations, three of which the upstream lab independently adopted after v40.

2. The systems under test

2.1 Lineage and the v40 recipe

`hp` is the integer-exact context-mixing (CM) compressor in odin-loki/CompressionAlgorithm (vendored into Cypha as `native/third_party/hp`, reduced to the later *gate24* recipe). The upstream tree is an ablation lab: every model and mixer change is a compile-time switch in `hp/include/hp/features.hpp`, and the lab log (`RECORD.md`) accepts or rejects one switch at a time on the first 8 MiB of enwik8 at `--mem 22`. Accepted switches stack into numbered champions (v5 … v93).

HP40 is champion **v40** of that log:

> `v40 = v39 + o3/o4+5 − 1,721,462 / 1.641 bpc, RT PASS` (`RECORD.md` line 827)

The repository keeps only the *latest* champion's flag file (`hp/tools/v78_flags.ps1`, which now tracks v93), and the current upstream defaults have drifted (most later flags are now default-on and `HP_SLOT_MAX` is hard-capped at 22). v40 therefore cannot be rebuilt from upstream HEAD. We rebuilt it from the oldest commit that still has every v40 switch individually controllable (`0b1ced2`, 2026-09-12, the v47 board) with the default flag set plus the 39 switches accepted between v5 and v40 and the `SLOT_MAX=32` cap, walked in order from the log (`data/v40_flags.txt`):

step	switch(es) accepted	8 MiB bytes (log)
v5	`MIXER_SKIP=24`, `SPARSE_UTF8`	1,798,335
v6–v7	`SENWORD`, `GATE_ARGMAX`	1,795,356
v8–v10	`SLOT_GROW` (replaced v8's `SLOT_SIZES`), `GATE_WORDPOS`, `STATE_TABLE2`, `SLOT_GROW_EXTRA`	1,781,301
v11–v13	`SENT_STREAM`, `MATCH_18`, `QUOTE_STACK`	1,775,314
v14–v25	`SLOT_WORD2…9` (word/wbi tables +8 bits), `MATCH_01/02`, `WMATCH_4`, `SLOT_S3`, `SLOT_WSTR2`, `SLOT_MAX` 29→31	1,747,228
v26–v28	`SENT_MEM`, `SLOT_S4`, `MATCH_05`	1,745,709
v29–v40	`SLOT_O34…O34E`, `SLOT_O6…O6F`, `MATCH_GROW`, `SLOT_MAX=32`	**1,721,462**

Of the 39 switches, 25 only **grow hash tables** (they add table bits to the order-3/4/6, word, word-bigram and sentence models). That fact dominates HP40's memory profile (§5.3).

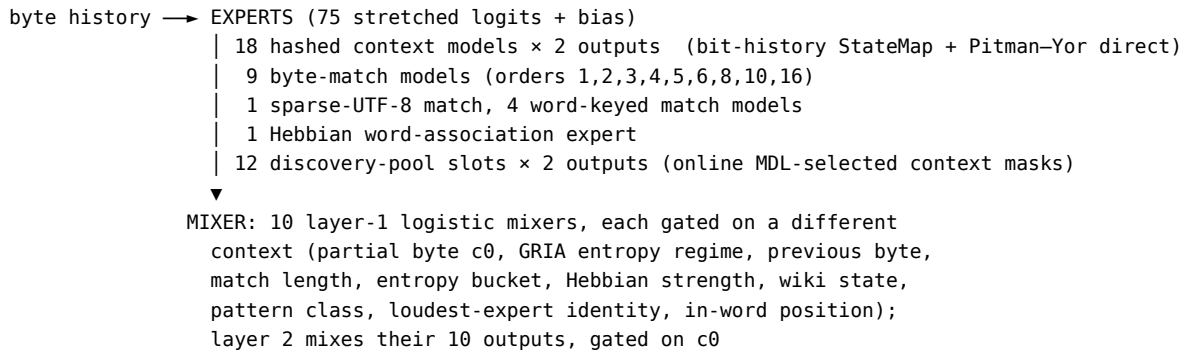
Reproduction. Built with GCC 13.3, `-O3 -march=native -std=c++20`, the rebuilt HP40 compresses `enwik8.8mb` (SHA-256 `09f6dd72…ee8e`) at `--mem 22` to **1,721,462 bytes**, byte-identical to the log entry. This is the anchor for every other number in the paper.

2.2 HP40-Lite

HP40-Lite is HP40 with **fewer experts**: the same code, flags and archive format family, with whole expert families switched off. Five of the families had no switch upstream (the sparse `sp13/sp24`, column, tag and word-bigram context models, and the Hebbian expert), so we added five default-on switches (`patches/hp40_lite_switches.patch`). With every switch at its default the patched tree reproduces HP40 byte-for-byte: identical archives on three test files, and it decodes HP40's 8 MiB anchor archive exactly (§4.3). Which families Lite drops is decided by data in §7, not by hand.

2.3 Per-bit pipeline

Every byte is coded MSB-first as eight binary decisions; encoder and decoder run the same predictor, so the compressor is symmetric in time and memory.



```
  ▼
APM ×3 (c0; previous byte×c0; GRIA bucket×c0) → final p (12-bit)
  ▼
32-bit binary arithmetic coder
  ▼
update(bit): every table, mixer weight and APM learns online
```

There is no floating point anywhere in the codec path, so archives are bit-reproducible across machines (§4.3).

2.4 Expert inventory

family	models	mixer inputs	context	table bits @ mem 22
order-n CMs	o1, o2, o3, o4, o6	10	last n bytes	22, 22, 27, 27, 28
word CM	word	2	hash of current word	**31**
sparse CMs	sp13, sp24	4	bytes 1,3 / 2,4 back	22
column CM	col	2	byte above in previous line	22
tag CM	tag	2	markup nesting / wiki context key	25
word-bigram CM	wbi	2	previous word × current word	**31**
word-stream CM	wstr	2	first-char / previous-word streams	25
bracket CM	brk	2	open-bracket/quote stack	22
link CM	link	2	wiki link word	25
numeric CM	num	2	numeric field state	22
sentence-word CM	sen	2	body-prose word hash	25
sentence-stream CM	sentst	2	sentence-boundary word	26
sentence-memory CM	sentmem	2	hash of a similar earlier sentence	22
byte match	m1 … m16	9	longest match at 9 orders	buffer 26, index 23
sparse-UTF-8 match	sutf8	1	gap-1 match for escaped UTF-8	26 / 23
word match	wm1 … wm4	4	match keyed on 1–4 previous words	26 / 23
Hebbian	hebb	1	learned word→word association	22
discovery pool	disc0 … disc11	24	online-selected 16-byte masks	22
bias	—	1	partial byte	—
total	**45 models**	**76**		

Most of the families above were built for Wikipedia XML (enwik8/9 is the Hutter Prize corpus): `tag`, `link`, `brk`, `sen`, `sentst`, `sentmem`, the wiki-state mixer gate, and the word families. A general-purpose compressor has to cope with executables, databases, images, PDFs and tarballs too; how these text-specialist experts behave on such data is one of the questions the paper answers.

3. Method

3.1 Corpora

set	files	bytes	role
Canterbury (classic)	11	2,810,784	small mixed files: text, C, Lisp, HTML, man page, Excel, fax image, SPARC binary
Calgary (large)	18	3,251,493	text, papers, source, object code, geophysics data, image, news
Silesia-1M: first 1 MiB of each Silesia file	12	12,582,912	modern mix: tar of source, x86 DLL, MRI, databases, PDF, XML, star catalogue, X-ray
enwik8.8mb	1	8,388,608	the Hutter-Prize text HP40 was tuned on
General-purpose (GP) set = all of the above	**42**	**27,033,797**	headline evaluation

set	files	bytes	role
Tuning set: 256 KiB from offset 4 MiB of each Silesia file + 512 KiB of enwik8 at offset 60 MB	13	3,670,016	Lite expert search only (disjoint from the GP set)
Silesia, full (baselines only)	12	211,938,580	context for the 1 MiB truncation

Silesia is truncated to 1 MiB per file because HP40 runs at roughly 10 KB/s (§4.2); the full corpus would take about seven hours per direction per setting. The tuning set is cut from different offsets of the same files and from a different region of enwik8, so the expert choice for Lite is not fitted to the evaluation bytes.

3.2 Baselines

gzip 1.12 `-9`; bzip2 1.0.8 `-9`; xz 5.4.5 `-9e` (single thread); zstd 1.5.5 `-19 --long=27` and `--ultra -22 --long=27` (single thread); brotli 1.1.0 `-q 11 -w 24`; lz4 1.9.4 `-12`. All run as stdin→stdout pipes. These are the general-purpose tools a user would otherwise choose. No other CM compressor (paq8px, cmix) was run, so HP40's standing among CM compressors is outside the scope of this study.

3.3 Settings

HP40 is evaluated at its tuned setting `--mem 22` and swept over `--mem 16, 18, 20` to map the memory/ratio trade-off. The Lite search runs at `--mem 18` (700 MB per job, so four jobs fit in RAM; at `--mem 20` four parallel jobs spent a large share of their time zeroing pages); the chosen Lite is then evaluated at every setting HP40 is.

3.4 Measurements

- **Size**: archive bytes including HP's 29-byte header; bits per byte (bpc) = 8 × archive / input.
- **Time**: wall, user and system seconds of the compressor process, taken from `wait4()` rusage.
- **Memory**: peak RSS (`ru_maxrss`) of the same process.
- **Correctness**: every decompressed output is compared to the input by SHA-256.
- **CPU profile**: `perf record -e cpu-clock` (the VM exposes no hardware counters) on the optimised binary, plus a `-fno-inline` build so time can be charged to components (context models, match models, mixer, APM, coder). The no-inline build distorts absolute time; only its *shares* are used.
- **Expert mining**: a diagnostic driver (`scripts/mine.cpp`) runs the real predictor over a file and records, for every coded bit, the cost −log2 p of each of the 75 experts' own prediction, the final cost, and which expert was cheapest. A 1-in-29 sample of the raw stretched predictions feeds the correlation and rank analysis (`analyze_mine.py`). The driver links the codec read-only, so it measures exactly what the compressor computes.

3.5 Platform

One VM: Intel Xeon @ 2.80 GHz, 4 vCPUs (no SMT), 128 KiB L1d / 4 MiB L2 per core, 33 MiB shared L3, 15 GiB RAM, no swap, Linux 6.18, transparent huge pages `madvise` (HP does not request them). GCC 13.3.

To finish in reasonable time, the GP-set runs of the HP family shared the machine with two or three other single-threaded jobs (each job on its own core, but sharing memory bandwidth and the L3). Their sizes are exact, but their times (and the baselines', also run alongside other jobs) are upper bounds. Table 3 repeats the key timings with one job alone on the machine.

4. Results

4.1 Compression ratio

Table 1 gives archive bytes per corpus; bits per byte are in brackets (full per-file table: `data/tables.md`, Table C; Figure 1).

Table 1. Archive bytes on the general-purpose set (27,033,797 bytes, 42 files)

compressor	Calgary	Canterbury	Silesia-1M	enwik8.8mb	**total**	vs xz -9e
HP40 (mem 22)	697,974 (1.717)	364,487 (1.037)	3,472,235 (2.208)	1,721,462 (1.642)	**6,256,158 (1.851)**	**−20.1%**
HP40-Lite (mem 22)	704,110 (1.732)	372,811 (1.061)	3,514,543 (2.234)	1,740,566 (1.660)	**6,332,030 (1.874)**	**−19.1%**
HP40 mem 20	699,139 (1.720)	365,527 (1.040)	3,490,323 (2.219)	1,731,114 (1.651)	6,286,103 (1.860)	−19.7%
Lite mem 20	706,059 (1.737)	374,569 (1.066)	3,530,600 (2.245)	1,751,417 (1.670)	6,362,645 (1.883)	−18.7%

compressor	Calgary	Canterbury	Silesia-1M	enwik8.8mb	**total**	vs xz -9e
HP40 mem 18	703,342 (1.731)	367,890 (1.047)	3,519,083 (2.237)	1,758,265 (1.677)	6,348,580 (1.879)	−18.9%
Lite mem 18	709,785 (1.746)	377,800 (1.075)	3,570,896 (2.270)	1,782,364 (1.700)	6,440,845 (1.906)	−17.7%
Lite-L5 mem 18	708,536 (1.743)	371,905 (1.059)	3,530,806 (2.245)	1,782,178 (1.700)	6,393,425 (1.892)	−18.3%
HP40 mem 16	712,072 (1.752)	372,843 (1.061)	3,572,652 (2.271)	1,816,118 (1.732)	6,473,685 (1.916)	−17.3%
Lite mem 16	720,215 (1.772)	384,046 (1.093)	3,619,512 (2.301)	1,846,659 (1.761)	6,570,432 (1.944)	−16.1%
xz -9e	883,752 (2.174)	493,080 (1.403)	4,147,436 (2.637)	2,303,468 (2.197)	7,827,736 (2.316)	0
brotli -q11 -w24	856,672 (2.108)	490,662 (1.397)	4,199,624 (2.670)	2,288,519 (2.183)	7,835,477 (2.319)	+0.1%
bzip2 -9	866,501 (2.132)	542,710 (1.545)	4,102,930 (2.609)	2,448,077 (2.335)	7,960,218 (2.356)	+1.7%
zstd –ultra -22 –long	922,123 (2.269)	521,080 (1.483)	4,473,396 (2.844)	2,365,633 (2.256)	8,282,232 (2.451)	+5.8%
zstd -19 –long	922,148 (2.269)	521,080 (1.483)	4,474,482 (2.845)	2,365,695 (2.256)	8,283,405 (2.451)	+5.8%
gzip -9	1,059,335 (2.606)	730,625 (2.079)	5,021,623 (3.193)	3,090,418 (2.947)	9,902,001 (2.930)	+26.5%
lz4 -12	1,248,336 (3.071)	935,398 (2.662)	5,564,138 (3.538)	3,545,863 (3.382)	11,293,735 (3.342)	+44.3%

- **HP40 is 20.1% smaller than xz -9e** and brotli-11 over the whole set, and 16–26% smaller on every corpus. Its lead is largest on its home ground (enwik8 −25.3%, Canterbury −26.1%) and smallest on Silesia (−16.3%).
- **Per file** (41 distinct files; `pic` and `ptt5` are the same bytes), HP40 or Lite is the smallest archive on **39**. The exceptions:
  - the CCITT fax bitmap `pic` (xz 39,860 vs HP40 42,014, **+5.4%**): HP40 has no two-dimensional image context, and LZ's long matches over runs of white scan lines win;
  - Calgary `paper4` (13 KB of English), where brotli's built-in English dictionary edges out HP40 by 21 bytes (4,283 vs 4,304).
- **The gains are smallest where there is least structure for a context model to find**: `mozilla` −3.1% (a tar whose first MiB is mostly already-compressed members), `sao` −6.1% (binary star-catalogue records), `sum` −10.9%, `geo` −11.7% and `obj1` −12.8% (small object code and float data).
- **The gains are largest on structured data**: `kennedy.xls` **−63.0%** (19,214 vs 51,868 bytes), `nci` −32.2%, `webster` −30.4%, `reymont` (PDF) −30.0%, `xml` −29.2%.
- **HP40-Lite** is 1.21% larger than HP40 overall (Calgary +0.9%, Canterbury +2.3%, Silesia-1M +1.2%, enwik8 +1.1%). Without `kennedy.xls` the gap is 1.13%. Lite is *smaller* than HP40 on the two images (`mr`, `pic`). The 1.21% on the evaluation set is *below* the 1.48% it cost on the disjoint tuning set, so the expert selection did not overfit.
- **Table size matters little.** From `--mem 22` down to 16, HP40 grows by only 0.5% (mem 20), 1.5% (mem 18) and 3.5% (mem 16), while its memory shrinks 56× (Table 2). At 195 MiB HP40 still beats xz -9e by 17.3%.

4.2 Speed and memory

Table 2. Time and memory on the GP set. HP rows ran with two or three other HP jobs on the 4-core VM (§3.5), so their wall times are upper bounds; Table 3 has clean single-job timings.

compressor	compress	KiB/s	decompress	peak RSS	round trip
HP40 (mem 22)	53.0 min	8.3	≈ compress	10.6 GiB	8 MiB anchor byte-exact (§4.3)
HP40-Lite (mem 22)	24.4 min	18.1	≈ compress	6.2 GiB	—
HP40 mem 20	32.8 min	13.4	≈ compress	2.7 GiB	—
Lite mem 20	19.2 min	23.0	≈ compress	1,598 MiB	—
HP40 mem 18	30.0 min	14.7	29.4 min	704 MiB	all 42 byte-exact
Lite mem 18	17.5 min	25.1	17.0 min	418 MiB	all 42 byte-exact
HP40 mem 16	25.6 min	17.2	≈ compress	195 MiB	—
Lite mem 16	13.9 min	31.7	≈ compress	123 MiB	—
xz -9e	23.4 s	1,127	0.8 s	138 MiB	all 42 byte-exact
brotli -q11 -w24	76.8 s	344	0.3 s	111 MiB	all 42 byte-exact
zstd –ultra -22 –long	59.3 s	446	0.3 s	660 MiB	all 42 byte-exact
bzip2 -9	3.0 s	8,841	1.9 s	18 MiB	all 42 byte-exact
gzip -9	3.2 s	8,296	0.4 s	18 MiB	all 42 byte-exact

"≈ compress": decompression was not timed on the whole set for these rows. CM decoding repeats the encoder's work bit for bit, and where it was timed (mem 18 rows, Table 3) it took the same time as compression.

Table 3. Single-job timings (one job alone on the VM; enwik8.1mb + Silesia ooffice + Calgary book1 = 2,865,923 bytes; `data/clean_timing*.jsonl`)

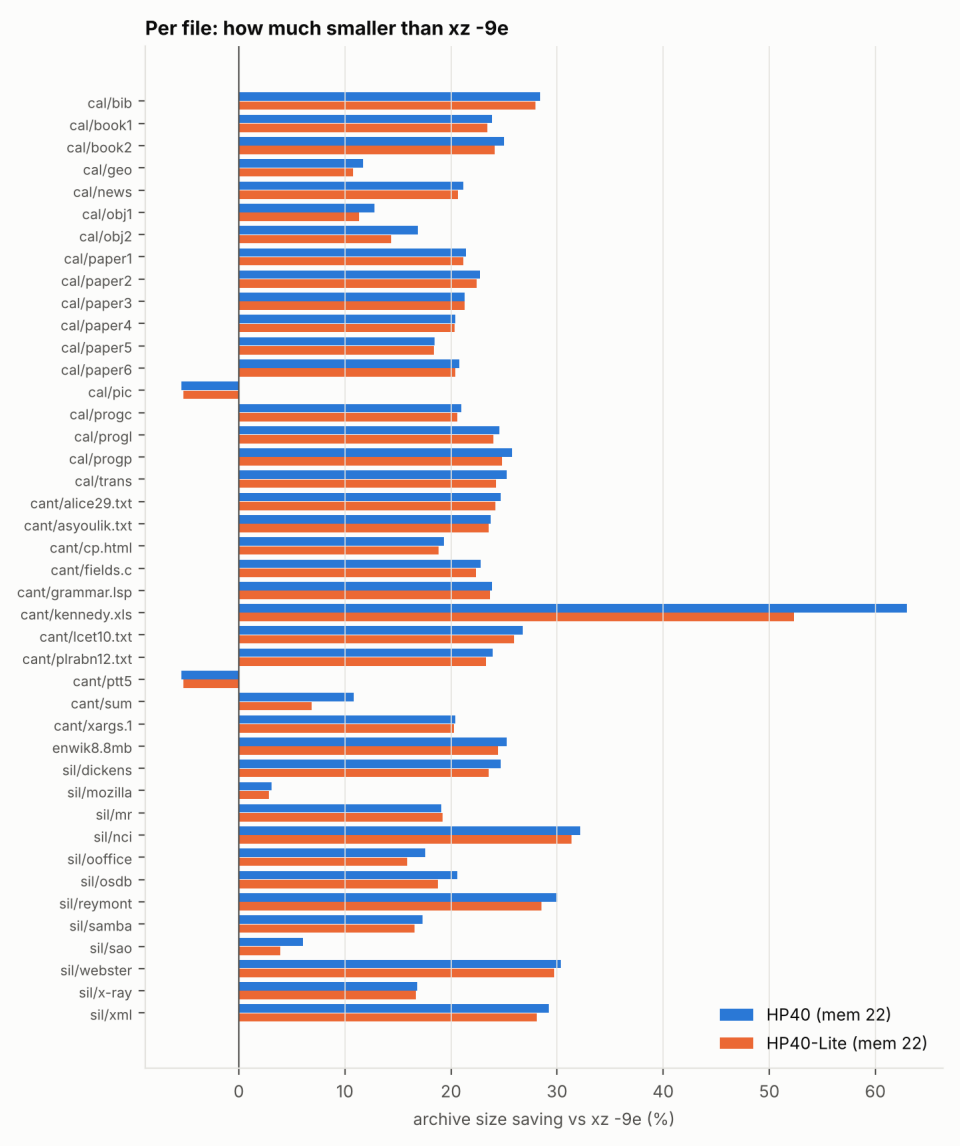


Figure 1. Archive size saving over xz -9e for each of the 42 files (positive = smaller than xz).

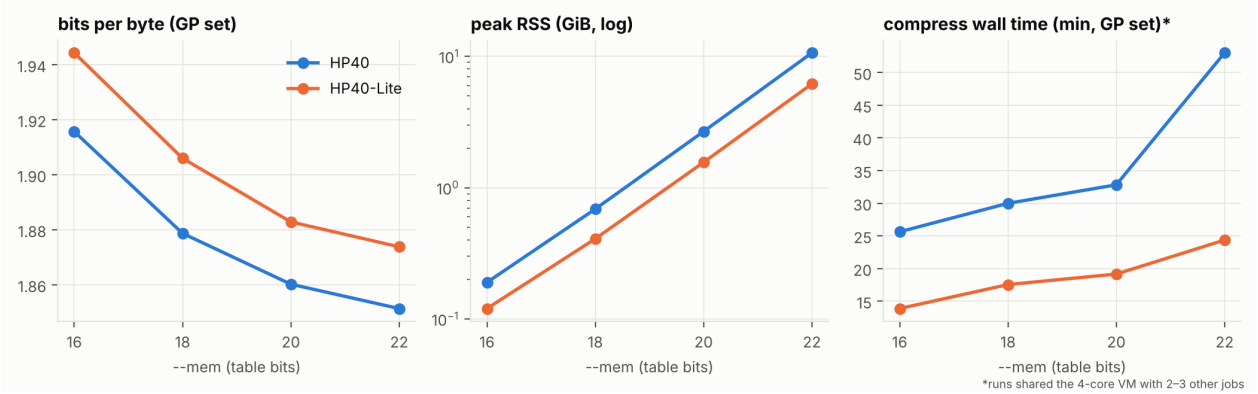


Figure 2. The `--mem` sweep: ratio is nearly flat while memory grows 4× per step.

compressor	bpc	compress wall	of which kernel	KiB/s (wall)	KiB/s (user CPU only)	decompress wall	peak RSS	round trip
HP40, mem 22	2.296	310.3 s	67.4 s	9.0	11.6	294.9 s	10.6 GiB	3/3 byte-exact
HP40-Lite, mem 22	2.326	148.5 s	11.4 s	18.8	20.6	149.7 s	6.2 GiB	3/3 byte-exact
HP40, mem 18	2.351	202.6 s	1.4 s	13.8	14.0	201.2 s	690 MiB	3/3 byte-exact
HP40-Lite, mem 18	2.391	114.3 s	0.8 s	24.5	24.9	113.0 s	404 MiB	3/3 byte-exact
xz -9e	2.918	2.5 s	1.0 s	1120.5	1905.8	0.1 s	76 MiB	3/3 byte-exact
brotli -q11 -w24	2.897	8.6 s	0.4 s	327.2	349.4	0.1 s	31 MiB	3/3 byte-exact
zstd –ultra -22 –long	3.029	8.2 s	6.4 s	341.2	1613.3	0.0 s	653 MiB	3/3 byte-exact
bzip2 -9	2.919	0.3 s	0.0 s	10182.5	10954.9	0.2 s	17 MiB	3/3 byte-exact

Run alone, HP40 at `--mem 22` codes **9.0 KiB/s** (11.6 KiB/s counting user CPU only), and 22% of its wall time is the kernel zeroing tables. Lite takes **52% less time** at `--mem 22` and **44% less** at `--mem 18`. HP40 is also slower at mem 22 than at mem 18 *excluding* kernel time (11.6 vs 14.0 KiB/s of user CPU): bigger tables mean more cache misses (§5.2). Decompression takes the same time as compression in every case. xz -9e compresses about 124× faster than HP40 and decompresses about 2,800× faster.

Figure 3 places every compressor on a ratio/speed plane. HP40 and Lite sit alone in the bottom-left corner, about 0.46 bits per byte below the best LZ/BWT compressors and two orders of magnitude slower. Within the HP family, **a Lite setting beats HP40 at mem 18 and at mem 16 on both axes**: Lite at mem 22 is smaller (1.874 vs 1.879 bpc) and faster than HP40 at mem 18, and Lite at mem 20 is smaller (1.883 vs 1.916) and faster than HP40 at mem 16. Full HP40 is only worth running at mem 20–22, when the last 1% matters more than time and memory.

Figure 4 shows time against file size. At `--mem 22`, HP40 spends 17–36 s on any file however small, so every file under about 100 KB costs about the same. At `--mem 18` the floor drops below 1 s. The cause is table zeroing (§5.3).

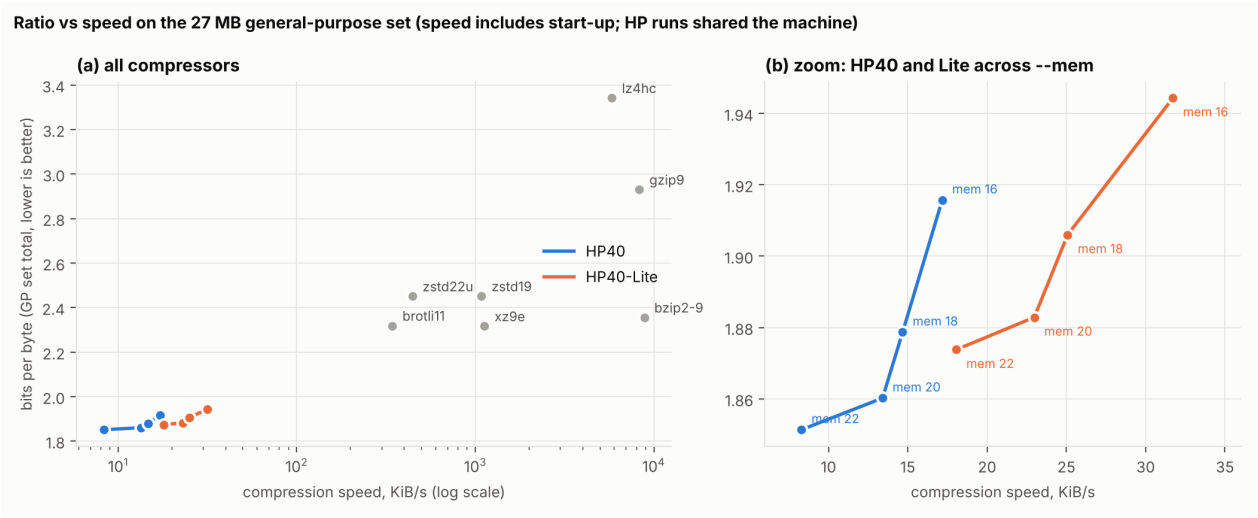


Figure 3. Ratio against compression speed. (a) all compressors; (b) the HP family across `--mem`.

4.3 Correctness

- **Anchor:** the rebuilt HP40 writes the 1,721,462-byte archive the upstream log records for v40 on `enwik8.8mb` (encode 820–902 s, 10.6 GiB). That archive, decoded by the binary that `scripts/build.sh` produces from the *patched* tree, returns the original 8,388,608 bytes (SHA-256 `09f6dd72…ee8e`) in 779 s. This verifies the `--mem 22` round trip, and shows that the Lite switches, when left on, do not change HP40 anywhere in the 8 MiB stream.
- **Round trip:** all 84 HP40 and Lite archives of the GP set at `--mem 18` decode to SHA-256-identical files, as do all baseline archives.
- **Determinism:** repeated runs and rebuilds (`-O1` and `-O3`) produce identical archives; the codec has no floating point.

5. Profiling

5.1 Where the CPU goes

Optimised build (`-O3`, `perf record -e cpu-clock`, `enwik8.1mb`, `--mem 22`). The compiler inlines every model into two functions, so this view separates only the codec from the kernel:

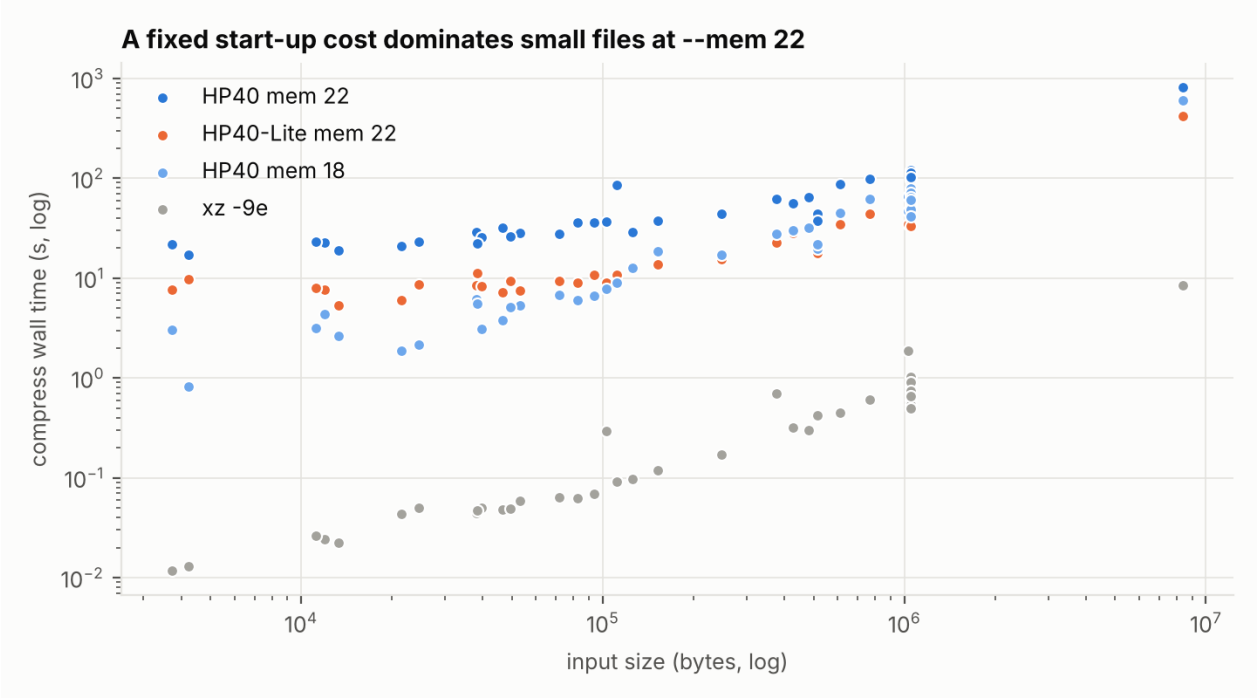


Figure 4. Compression time against input size: a fixed start-up floor at `--mem 22`.

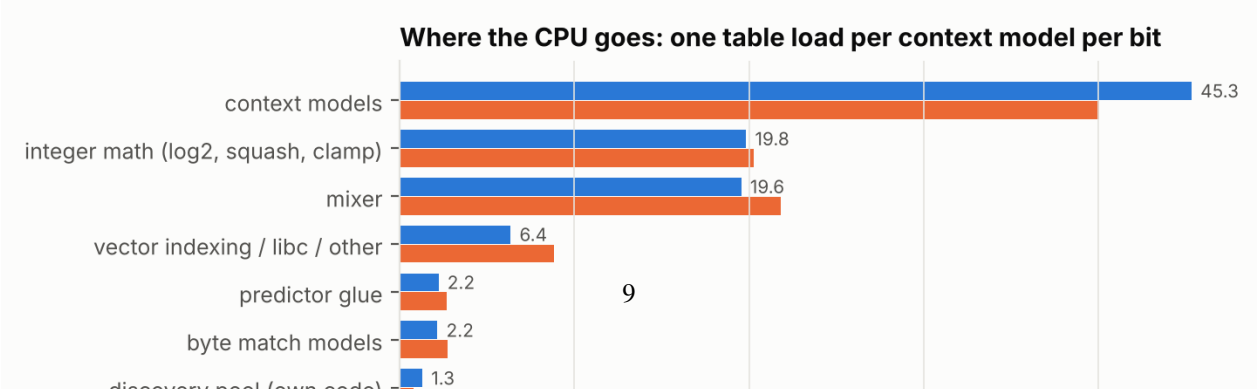
symbol	HP40	HP40-Lite
`Predictor::predict` (all experts + mixer + APM)	52.1%	63.0%
`Predictor::update` (all learning)	15.0%	21.0%
kernel `clear_page_erms` (zeroing the tables)	**23.6%**	3.3%
`end_of_byte`, `memset`, page faults, other	9.3%	12.7%

On a 1 MiB input, a quarter of HP40's CPU time at `--mem 22` is the kernel zeroing 10.6 GiB of tables before and while they are first touched (§5.3).

No-inline build (`-O2 -fno-inline`, `--mem 18`, `enwik8.1mb`; shares are of self time; disabling inlining inflates small helpers such as `clamp_int` and `squash`, so read the ranking, not the absolute values):

component	HP40	Lite	HP40 on `ooffice`
context models (`ContextModel`, `StateMap`, PY estimate)	**45.3%**	40.0%	41.5%
integer math (`log2_q16`, `squash`, `stretch`, `clamp`)	19.8%	20.3%	21.3%
mixer (10 layer-1 dot products, layer 2, updates)	19.6%	21.8%	21.8%
vector indexing, libc, other	6.4%	8.8%	6.5%
predictor glue	2.2%	2.7%	1.9%
byte match models	2.2%	2.8%	2.3%
discovery pool (own code only)	1.3%	0.8%	1.2%
APM ×3	1.0%	1.1%	1.2%
Hebbian, sentence memory, word match, text state machines, GRIA	1.6%	1.1%	1.6%
arithmetic coder	0.05%	0.09%	0.05%

The profile is the same on text and on an x86 DLL: HP40 does the same work per bit whatever the data.



5.2 The bottleneck is one DRAM load per model per bit

`perf annotate` on `ContextModel::predict` puts **95% of its samples on one instruction**: the one retiring the load `state_ = t_[idx_]`, the bit-history slot for this context. The index is a hash of the context and the partial byte, so every lookup is a random access into a table of 4 MiB–4 GiB. HP40 does about 30 such lookups per coded bit (18 context models + 12 discovery slots), 240 per byte. That load alone is about a third of total CPU time. The coder (0.05%) and the APMs (1%) are irrelevant.

HP40 is therefore **memory-latency bound**, which explains three observations:

- speed falls as `--mem` grows (bigger tables, fewer cache hits) even after start-up is excluded;
- Lite's speed-up (1.8× in user CPU, Table 3) tracks its cut in random lookups per bit (30 → 16: 12 context models + 4 slots, 1.9×), not its cut in expert count (75 → 43, 1.7×);
- the classic CM remedy applies directly: keep the bit histories for a whole nibble in one 64-byte cache-line bucket, as paq8 and lpaq do, so a model costs about two cache misses per byte instead of eight. HP40 (v40) has one 2-byte slot per bit, with no bucket and no checksum (the lab added a checksummed 3-probe index, `HASH_CHK`, after v62).

5.3 Memory

Peak RSS is set by table sizes alone and is **independent of the input**: a 3,721-byte file and an 8 MiB file both use 10.6 GiB at `--mem 22`. The analytic accounting in `scripts/memacct.py` reproduces the measured peaks within 4% at `--mem 18`–`22`; at `--mem 16` a fixed ~20 MiB of code, mixer weights and APM tables accounts for the gap (Figure 6):

`--mem`	HP40 analytic	HP40 measured	Lite analytic	Lite measured
16	175 MiB	195 MiB	102 MiB	123 MiB
18	698 MiB	704 MiB	408 MiB	418 MiB
20	2,794 MiB	2.7 GiB	1,630 MiB	1,598 MiB
22	11,176 MiB	10.6 GiB	6,520 MiB	6.2 GiB

At `--mem 22`, 73% of HP40's memory is two tables, word and word-bigram (2^{31} two-byte slots each, from the eight `SLOT_WORD` switches); the 14 match models' private 64 MiB history buffers are another 0.9 GiB. Lite's saving is almost entirely the word-bigram table.

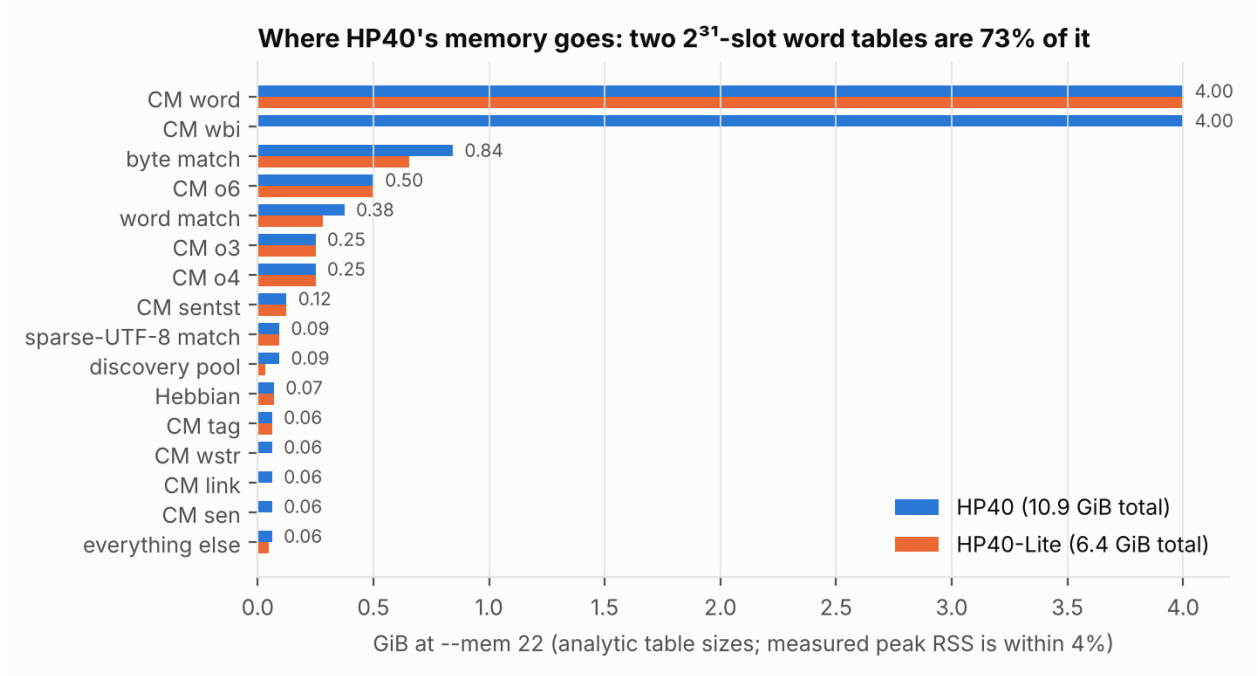


Figure 6. Table memory at `--mem 22` by component, HP40 and Lite (analytic).

Start-up. Every table is a value-initialised `std::vector`, so all of it is written before the first byte is coded. On this VM that costs, for a 3.7 KB input at `--mem 22`, **36 s for HP40** (33.7 s of it kernel time) and **5 s for Lite**. The cost is not linear in size. A first-touch micro-benchmark (`scripts/touch.cpp`, `data/first_touch.txt`) zeroes fresh memory at 1.35 GiB/s up to 6 GiB but only 0.4–0.5 GiB/s beyond about 7 GiB, while rewriting already-mapped memory runs

at 4.3 GiB/s. The slow regime is the hypervisor backing guest pages on first touch (the guest kernel is a Firecracker build). On a host with ample free RAM, expect HP40's start-up to be a few seconds. The structural point stands on any machine: the cost is paid in full for every file, however small.

6. Data-mining the experts

The mining driver ran HP40 and HP40-Lite at `--mem 18` over one file of each of 18 data types (the 12 Silesia-1M files, enwik8's first MiB, and Calgary book1, geo, obj2, pic and Canterbury kennedy.xls) and logged every expert's cost on every coded bit (`data/mine_v40.json`, `data/mine_lite.json`). Calgary `pic` and Canterbury `ptt5` turned out to be the same file (byte-identical, same results), so 18 distinct types remain.

6.1 Mixing is where the compression comes from

data	HP40 bpc	best single expert	its bpc	mixing gain	effective rank	PCs for 90%	Lite Δ
book1 (novel)	2.084	o4 PY	2.680	22%	2.4	21	+0.7%
dickens (novels)	1.791	o4 PY	2.318	23%	2.3	20	+1.6%
enwik8 1 MiB	1.746	o4 PY	2.560	32%	2.5	24	+0.7%
webster (dictionary)	1.322	o4 PY	1.921	31%	2.3	19	+0.9%
reymont (PDF)	1.231	o4 PY	1.718	28%	2.2	18	+0.9%
xml (tar)	0.662	o4 PY	1.147	42%	1.7	10	+1.7%
nci (chem. table)	0.336	**col** PY	0.794	58%	1.6	9	+1.1%
samba (tar of source)	1.834	o3	2.533	28%	2.2	20	+0.9%
mozilla (tar of binaries)	4.761	o3	5.061	6%	2.0	16	+0.3%
obj2 (object code)	1.697	o3 PY	2.884	41%	2.8	24	+2.5%
ooffice (x86 DLL)	3.151	o3 PY	4.512	30%	4.2	28	+2.7%
kennedy.xls	0.163	o3	0.580	**72%**	2.8	22	**+33.5%**
osdb (database)	1.979	o3	2.705	27%	3.7	26	+1.9%
sao (star catalogue)	4.711	o2	5.913	20%	**7.2**	**36**	+3.7%
geo (seismic floats)	3.695	**sp24** PY	4.444	17%	4.2	28	+1.4%
mr (MRI)	1.639	o2	1.865	12%	3.4	18	−0.1%
x-ray (12-bit image)	3.428	o2	4.056	15%	3.4	27	+0.2%
pic / ptt5 (fax)	0.659	o1	0.830	21%	2.1	5	−0.3%

Mixing gain = 1 − HP40 ÷ best single expert in hindsight. *Effective rank* is the participation ratio of the eigenvalues of the 75×75 correlation matrix of expert logits (1 = all experts say the same thing, 75 = independent). "PY" marks the Pitman–Yor direct output of a context model; unmarked is the bit-history (indirect) output.

- **No single expert comes close.** The mix beats the best expert by 6–72% (median 27%). The best single expert is always a plain order-1 to order-4 model (or the column / sparse model on tabular and float data), never one of the Wikipedia-specific experts.
- **The expert set is low-rank.** The participation ratio is 1.6–7.2 out of 75, and 90% of the variance sits in 5–36 principal components. On text it is about 2.3; it rises on the binary, structured data where HP40 is weakest (sao 7.2, ooffice 4.2, geo 4.2). The experts disagree most exactly where they are least useful.
- **The most redundant pairs are near-duplicates**: word matches 1 and 3 (r = 0.99 on both text and code), byte matches of orders 8/10/16 (0.93–0.94), and adjacent orders' two outputs (o3/o4, o4/o6, 0.92–0.96). On ooffice the link and sentence-word models (both text features) correlate at 0.95: on binary data they collapse to the same degenerate context.

6.2 Who wins which bits

Averaged over the 18 types, the share of bits on which each family's prediction was the cheapest (`best_share`):

family	share	family	share
order-3 CM	15.8%	sparse sp24 / sp13	2.9% / 2.8%
order-1 CM	15.5%	sentence stream	2.1%
discovery pool (12 slots)	14.3%	word CM	1.9%
order-4 CM	12.2%	bracket	1.7%
order-2 CM	10.7%	word bigram	1.5%
order-6 CM	7.3%	column, tag	1.3% each
byte match (9 models)	4.4%	sentence memory	1.2%

family	share	family	share
		word stream, sparse-UTF-8, numeric, word match, link, sentence word, Hebbian	≤ 0.8% each

The bit-history (indirect) and Pitman–Yor (direct) outputs of the context models split the wins about evenly (49% / 45%), so the second output per model is not wasted. The seven families at the bottom of the table win under 1% of bits each; five of them are among the families HP40-Lite drops, and the ablation (§7) agrees that they are close to free to remove.

Figure 9 is the per-type view. The ratio panel shows the specialists clearly: `col` is nearly as good as the whole mix on `nci`, `sp24` is the best single expert on `geo` (4-byte floats, so bytes 2 and 4 back are the same field), and the word-keyed experts (word, wbi, word match, link, sentence) are 3–8× worse than the mix on every binary file, yet the mixer still has to evaluate them on every bit.

6.3 Where the bits go inside a byte

Share of coded bits by bit position (MSB first), averaged over types: **6.1, 10.5, 8.5, 15.0, 16.0, 16.6, 14.2, 13.1%**. The first three bits of a byte cost a quarter of the output (they choose among character classes, which the contexts predict well); the low five bits cost three quarters. This is the usual shape for bitwise CM and suggests nothing specific to HP40.

6.4 Learning dynamics

Figure 10 shows 64 KiB blocks. Text and the chemistry table are stable from the first block. The DLL fluctuates with section content. `mozilla`'s first MiB contains roughly 640 KiB of already-compressed members, where HP40 codes at up to **7.99 bits/byte**: it has no stored-block fallback, so it spends its full per-bit cost (about 10 KB/s) on bytes it cannot shrink. A general-purpose tool would detect such runs and store them.

6.5 What the mining says about Lite

Lite's mixed output is within 3.7% of HP40 on 17 of 18 types and slightly *better* on the two images (`mr`, fax). With fewer, less redundant experts its 90%-variance count drops from 5–36 to 5–23. The exception is **kennedy.xls** (+33.5%, 0.163 → 0.218 bpc). Re-running each ablation on that file (`data/kennedy_m18.jsonl`) isolates the cause: cutting the **discovery pool** from 12 to 4 slots costs +22.3% on its own, while every other dropped family costs at most +0.6% alone (+5.2% together). kennedy.xls is a spreadsheet of fixed-size records; the pool's online mask search finds record-aligned contexts that no hand-written model in HP40 provides, and four slots are not enough to hold them. HP40 reaches 0.16 bpc there and xz -9e 0.40, so Lite still beats every baseline. This is also the clearest evidence that the discovery pool is HP40's general-purpose engine: it is what adapts to structure the hand-written experts were not designed for.

7. Designing HP40-Lite from the data

7.1 Leave-one-family-out

Each of HP40's 20 switchable expert families was removed in turn and the variant compressed the 13-file tuning set at `--mem 18` (`data/abl_m18.jsonl`). HP40 itself writes 945,166 bytes for the set. CPU deltas were measured with four jobs sharing the machine, so treat them as ±3 points.

removed family	experts	Δ size	worst file	CPU	RSS
byte match order 8 (`m8`)	1	−0.001%	+0.05% nci	−1.0%	683 MiB
link CM	2	+0.003%	+0.05% enwik8	−2.8%	685 MiB
numeric CM	2	+0.005%	+0.06% webster	−2.9%	688 MiB
Hebbian	1	+0.005%	+0.04% xml	−0.4%	689 MiB
byte match order 5 (`m5`)	1	+0.006%	+0.03% samba	−1.6%	683 MiB
sentence-word CM	2	+0.015%	+0.07% enwik8	−4.5%	685 MiB
4th word match	1	+0.016%	+0.11% nci	−2.7%	688 MiB

removed family	experts	Δ size	worst file	CPU	RSS
word-stream CM	2	+0.028%	+0.14% osdb	−3.5%	685 MiB
sentence memory	2	+0.037%	+0.12% nci	−6.3%	688 MiB
all word matches	4	+0.064%	+0.43% nci	−5.1%	684 MiB
tag CM	2	+0.087%	+0.60% xml	−5.5%	685 MiB
sentence-stream CM	2	+0.093%	+0.61% nci	−5.5%	681 MiB
sparse-UTF-8 match	1	+0.103%	+0.44% ooffice	−3.4%	683 MiB
word-bigram CM (`wbi`)	2	+0.126%	+0.73% dickens	−9.4%	**433 MiB**
bracket CM	2	+0.144%	+0.62% enwik8	−2.6%	688 MiB
byte match orders 1+2	2	+0.241%	+0.58% mozilla	−3.1%	677 MiB
column CM	2	+0.247%	**+11.66% nci**	−4.2%	689 MiB
sparse CMs sp13+sp24	4	+0.418%	+2.09% ooffice	−7.9%	688 MiB
discovery pool 12→4 slots	16	+1.219%	+3.27% sao	**−27.1%**	685 MiB
discovery pool 12→1 slot	22	+1.561%	+4.24% sao	−37.4%	683 MiB

Three things stand out.

1. **Most of HP40's experts are individually redundant.** Fourteen families (26 experts, a third of the mixer) each cost at most 0.15% when removed alone, and no file loses more than 0.73%. Nine of them cost under 0.04%.
2. **The column model is a specialist with no substitute.** It looks cheap on average (+0.25%) but carries the fixed-width chemistry table `nci` (+11.7% without it). An average-only selection rule would have deleted it.
3. **The discovery pool is the CPU budget.** Its 12 slots are 24 mixer inputs and about 27–37% of CPU time. It matters most on binary records: the star catalogue `sao` is the worst tuning file when it shrinks, and on `kennedy.xls` it is worth 22% on its own (§6.5).

7.2 Interactions: removals are not additive

candidate	families dropped	experts left	Δ size (sum of singles)	Δ size (measured)	CPU	RSS
L3	9 near-free	61	+0.114%	+0.127%	−15.2%	663 MiB
L5	L3 + wbi	59	+0.240%	+0.285%	−18.0%	407 MiB
L1	14 cheap	49	+0.715%	+1.144%	−28.4%	385 MiB
L4 = HP40-Lite	**L5 + discovery 12→4**	**43**	+1.459%	**+1.482%**	**−43.2%**	**403 MiB**
L2	L1 + discovery 12→4	33	+1.934%	+2.355%	−52.1%	380 MiB

The nine near-free families are nearly free together too (L3 measures +0.127% against the +0.114% sum). Dropping all fourteen cheap families (L1) costs 60% more than the sum of the singles: the word-oriented experts (`wbi`, word streams, sentence word/stream, word matches, tag, bracket) cover for each other, so each looks redundant only while the others are present.

A greedy **add-back** from L1 confirms this (`data/addback_m18.jsonl`): putting any one family back recovers between 0.007% (`m8`) and 0.22% (bracket) of HP40's size, and the best recoveries per expert are the sparse-UTF-8 match (1,252 B per expert), bracket (1,053), tag (1,018), sentence stream (864) and word-bigram (858). No single family explains L1's loss; it is spread across the word cluster.

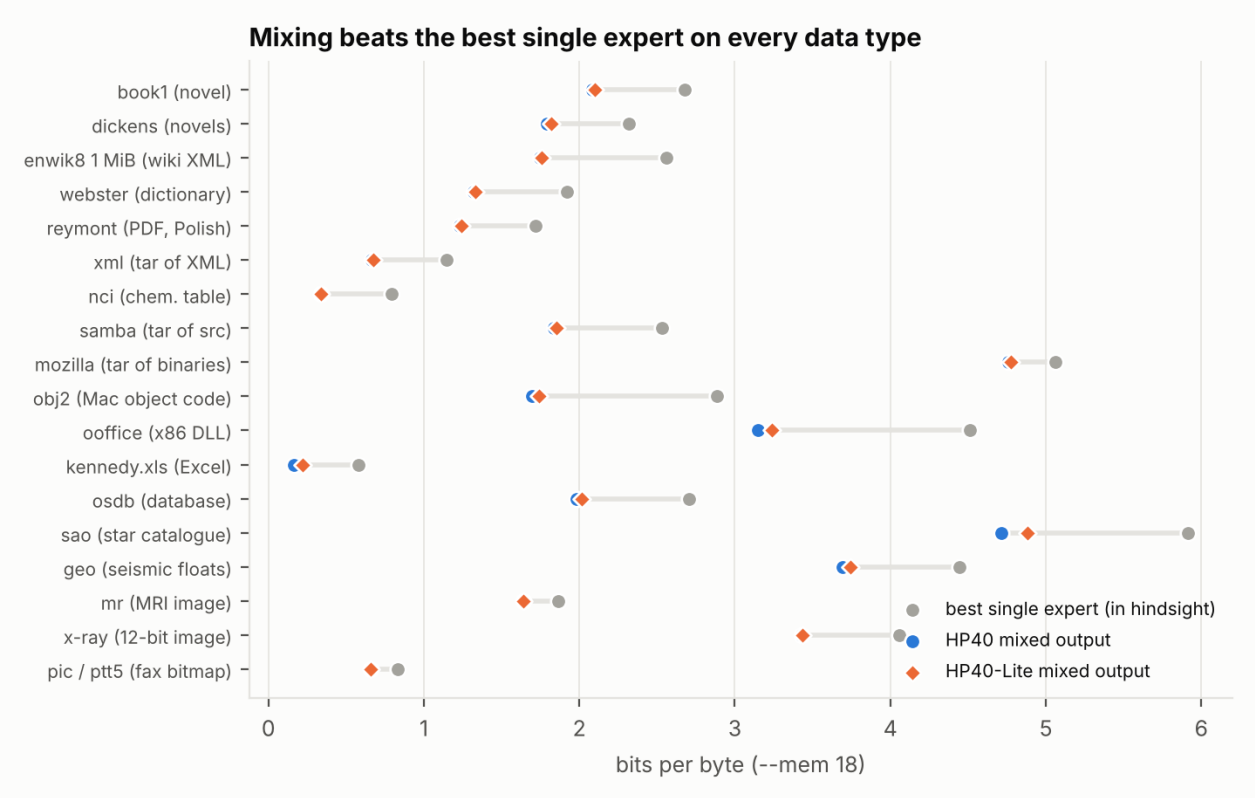


Figure 7. Best single expert (in hindsight) against the mixed output, per data type.

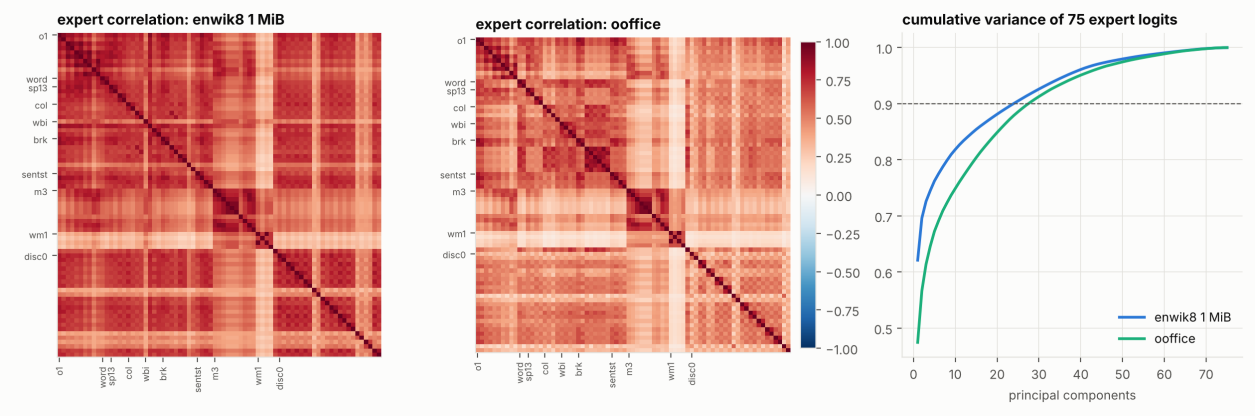


Figure 8. Correlation of the 75 expert logits on text and on an x86 DLL, and the cumulative variance spectrum.

7.3 The chosen Lite

HP40-Lite is **L4**: drop the nine near-free families and the word-bigram model, and cut the discovery pool from 12 slots to 4. It keeps every family with a measured specialist role (column, sparse, bracket, tag, sentence stream, sparse-UTF-8, three word matches, low-order byte matches).

```
-DHP_MATCH_18=0 -DHP_MATCH_05=0 -DHP_LINKWORD=0 -DHP_NUMERIC=0 -DHP_HEBB_EXPERT=0
-DHP_SENWORD=0 -DHP_WMATCH_4=0 -DHP_WORD_STREAMS=0 -DHP_SENT_MEM=0 -DHP_CM_WBI=0
-DHP_DISC_SLOTS=4
```

On the tuning set it is the best point we found on the size/CPU curve (1.48% larger for 43% less CPU; the discovery pool alone buys 27% CPU for 1.22%, and adding the ten other drops buys a further 16 points of CPU and the word-bigram table's memory for another 0.26%). L5 is the choice when size matters more than speed: +0.29% for −41% memory. Both are evaluated on the full GP set in §4 (Table 1).

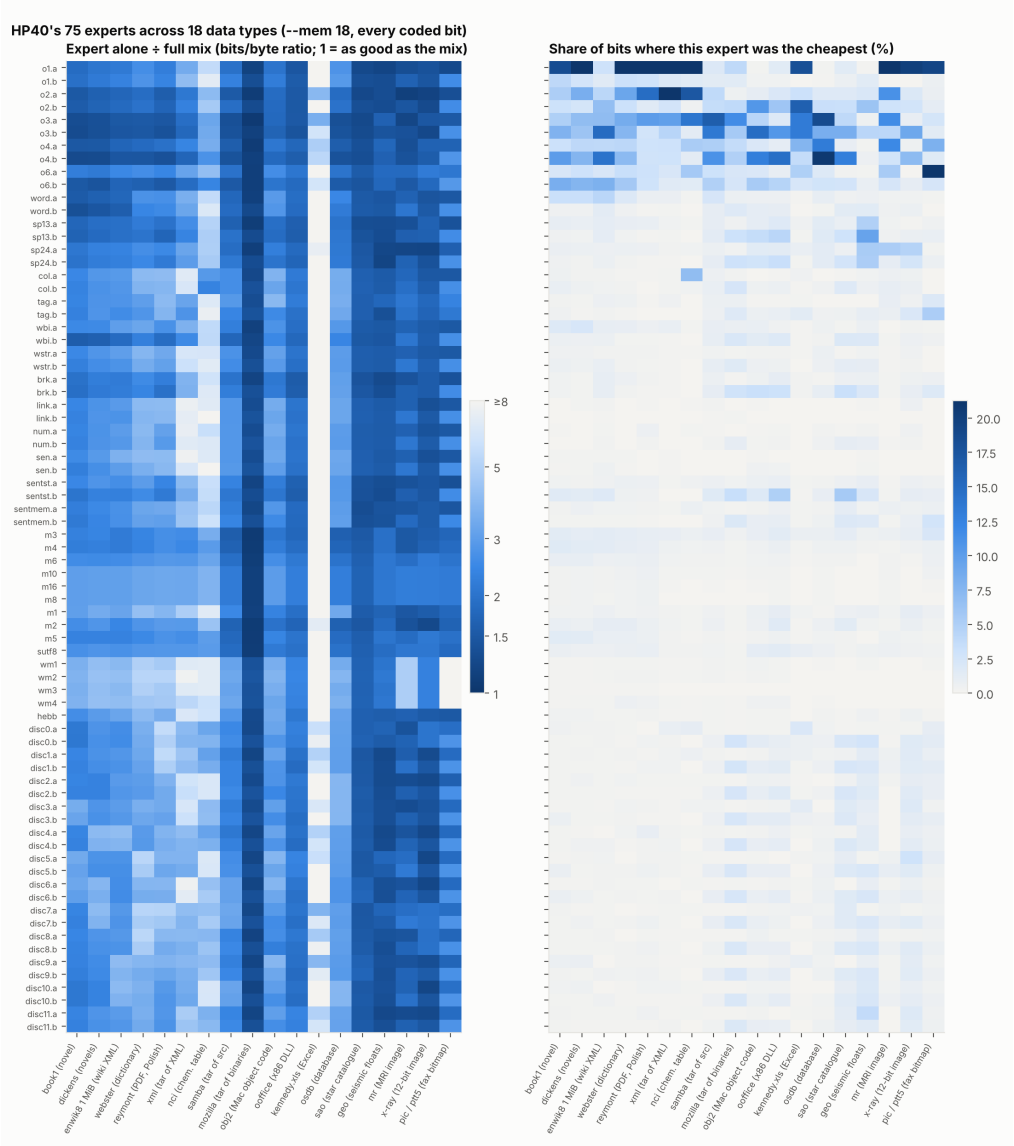


Figure 9. Every expert on every data type: standalone cost relative to the mix (left) and share of bits won (right).

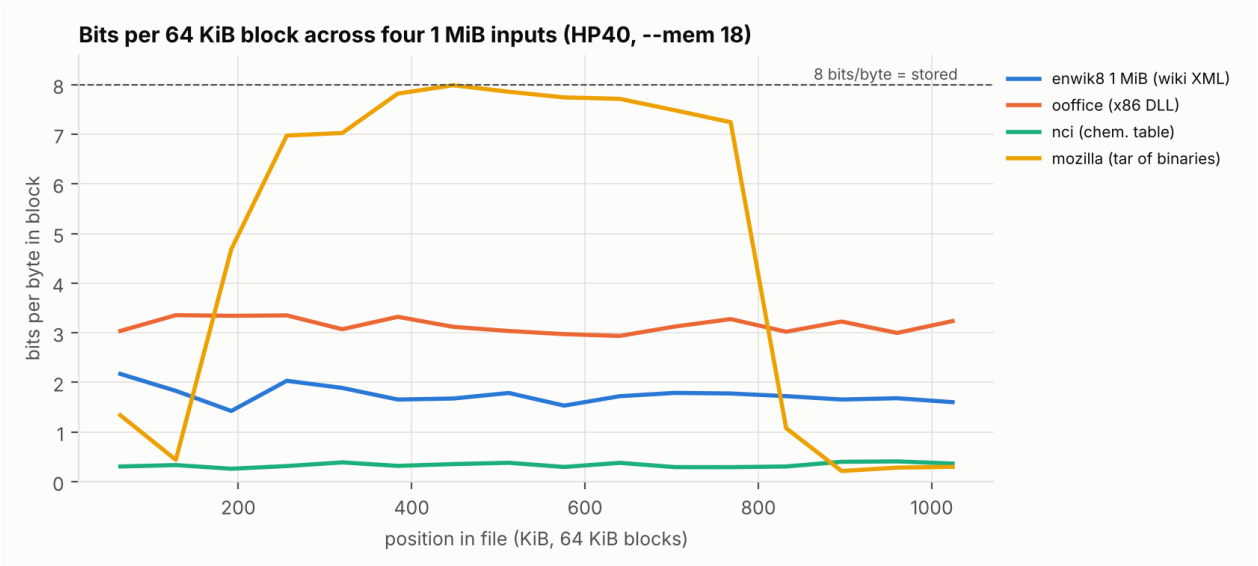


Figure 10. Bits per 64 KiB block across four 1 MiB inputs.

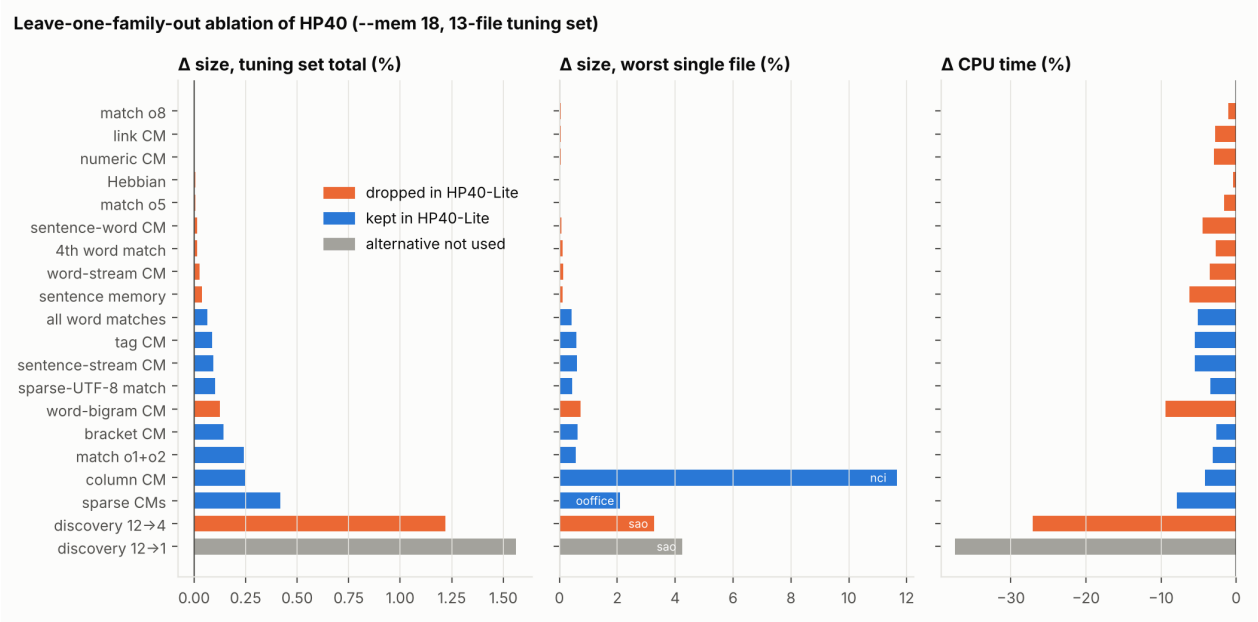


Figure 11. Leave-one-family-out ablation on the tuning set: size cost, worst-file cost and CPU saving.

8. Discussion

8.1 Is HP40 a good general-purpose compressor?

On ratio, yes, decisively. Although every switch in its recipe was accepted on Wikipedia XML, HP40 beats xz -9e by 20% on a 27 MB mix of text, source, executables, databases, images, PDFs and tarballs. It beats xz on every distinct file except one 1-bit fax image. Context mixing generalises because the mixer re-weights 75 experts per bit: the text specialists are simply ignored on binary data (§6), and the generic order-1…6, sparse, column, match and discovery experts carry it.

On cost, no, not at its tuned setting. At `--mem 22` HP40:

- runs at **8 KiB/s** in both directions, about 120–140× slower than xz -9e to compress and about 2,800× slower to decompress (CM is symmetric; LZ decoders are not);
- commits **10.6 GiB** of RAM for any input, including a 3.7 KB file;
- spends **17–36 s of fixed start-up** per file on this VM zeroing that memory (a few seconds on a host with free RAM, §5.3), which dominates every file under ~100 KB (Figure 4);
- is single-threaded and keeps no block structure, so it cannot use more cores and cannot seek.

The tuned setting is the wrong setting for general use. `--mem 18` keeps **94%** of the ratio advantage (−18.9% vs xz instead of −20.1%; archives 1.5% larger) in 0.7 GiB with sub-second start-up at 1.8× the speed (Table 2). HP40-Lite at `--mem 18` gives up another 1.5% for 44% less time and 41% less memory. These are the configurations to ship.

8.2 What the profile says to fix

The measurements point at six concrete changes. None of them requires a new model.

1. **Size tables to the input.** Ratio is flat in table size once the tables exceed the input's distinct contexts (Figure 2), so `--mem` should be set from the file size (e.g. `table_bits ≈ log2(input bytes) − 2`, clamped 16–22). That alone removes the fixed start-up from small files.
2. **Allocate lazily.** The tables are `std::vectors` value-initialised to zero, so every page is written before the first byte is coded. Allocating with `calloc`/anonymous `mmap` would let the kernel supply zero pages on first touch: start-up would go to near zero and RSS would track what the input actually touches.
3. **Cap the two word tables.** `SLOT_WORD2…9` give the word and word-bigram models 2^{31} slots each at `--mem 22`: 8 GiB, 73% of the footprint, for two experts that win 3.4% of bits (§6.2). The +8 bits were accepted on 8 MiB of Wikipedia, where the vocabulary is large; on general data the two models win 3.4% of bits, and removing the word-bigram model alone costs 0.13% (§7).
4. **Share the match history.** Fourteen match models each keep a private 64 MiB copy of the same input history (0.9 GiB).

5. **Detect incompressible runs.** On compressed members (`mozilla`) HP40 codes at 7.99 bits/byte at full per-bit cost. A stored-block escape would save the time with no loss of ratio.
6. **Gate experts by data type.** The word-keyed experts are 3–8× worse than the mix on every binary file, yet are evaluated on every bit. Switching expert families on a cheap text/binary detector would give Lite's speed on binary data and HP40's ratio on text.

Upstream has since made changes 2 and (in effect) 3: the current lab code allocates demand-zero hash tables via `mmap`/`VirtualAlloc` and hard-caps `HP_SLOT_MAX` at 22, which stops the word tables growing past 2^{22} slots (`RECORD.md`, "Throughput / RAM (kVersion 5)"). Change 4 landed in commit `058b25d`. HP40 predates all three.

On ratio, the evidence says where the remaining gains are. HP40 is weakest relative to xz on the fax bitmap (no 2-D image model), the star catalogue `sao` (fixed records of binary floats: highest effective rank, lowest mixing gain) and `mozilla` (compressed members). The PAQ family handles these with image, record-length and executable (E8/E9) models; HP40 has none.

8.3 HP40 vs HP40-Lite

Lite removes 32 of 75 experts. Five families were dead weight on general data (link, numeric, Hebbian, order-5 and order-8 matches: under 0.01% each when removed). The word-oriented cluster is redundant as a group but not individually: drop one and the others cover; drop all and the loss is 60% more than the parts. The discovery pool is the largest single CPU cost and, on record-structured binary data, a large ratio contributor. The column model is a specialist no other expert replaces.

For a user the choice is simple: Lite when time or memory matters (1.2–1.5% larger, 44–52% less time, about 40% less memory at every setting), HP40 when the last percent matters. The one data type where Lite falls well behind HP40 is the spreadsheet `kennedy.xls` (§6.5); it still beats every baseline there.

8.4 Threats to validity

- **One machine.** A 4-vCPU VM without hardware counters; some runs shared the box, and timings of runs made under load are marked. Ratios are exact and machine-independent (the codec has no floating point).
- **Truncated Silesia.** 1 MiB per Silesia file favours fast learners; CM usually gains more on long inputs, so these numbers likely understate HP40's ratio advantage on the full corpus.
- **Tuning and evaluation share source files.** Lite was chosen on different 256 KiB regions of the same Silesia files plus enwik8. Lite's evaluation-set loss (1.21%, Table 1) is slightly below its tuning-set loss (1.48%), which suggests no overfit, but other data could rank the families differently.
- **Search at `--mem 18`.** The ablation and the mining ran at `--mem 18`; Lite's loss at `--mem 22` is reported separately and agrees.
- **Rebuild.** HP40 was rebuilt from the v47-era tree with the v40 switches. It is byte-identical on the anchor (1,721,462 B), which is strong but not complete evidence that every code path matches the original v40 binary (paths that enwik8 never exercises could in principle differ).
- **Baselines.** No other CM compressor (paq8px, cmix) was run; HP40's place among CM compressors is not measured here.

9. Conclusion

HP40 is a very good compressor that was never meant to be a general-purpose one. Tuned only on Wikipedia, it still compresses an unrelated 27 MB mix 20% smaller than xz -9e and brotli-11, and loses to them on only two of 41 distinct files. Its model is general: the mixer quietly ignores the text experts on binary data, and the generic order-n, sparse, column, match and self-discovering context experts do the work. Its *engineering* is not general: at its tuned setting it commits 10.6 GiB and tens of seconds of start-up to every file, runs at 8 KiB/s in both directions, and spends a third of its time waiting on one random DRAM read per context model per bit.

Three findings carry over to any deployment:

1. **Use `--mem 16–18`, not 22.** Ratio drops 1.5–3.5%; memory drops 16–56× and start-up disappears.
2. **Use HP40-Lite.** With 43 of 75 experts it is 1.2% larger than HP40 and takes 44–52% less time with about 40% less memory. Lite at `--mem 22` is smaller *and* faster than HP40 at `--mem 18`, and Lite at 20 beats HP40 at 16.
3. **Fix the table layout before adding models.** Cache-line buckets, demand-zero allocation, input-sized tables, shared match history and a stored-block escape address every cost this study measured without touching the model.

The expert mining also gives the lab a ranking it lacked: the order-1…6 models and the discovery pool win 76% of all bits; the discovery pool is the component that adapts HP40 to data nobody wrote a model for (it alone is worth 22% on a spreadsheet); and seven text families win under 1% of bits each on general data.

Follow-up. Part II (§10–20) applies these findings: **hpd** is HP40-Lite with bucketed, prefetched tables, demand-zero memory, a record model, an x86 transform and parallel blocks. It is 1.55% smaller than HP40 on the GP set, 5.6× faster and uses 1/18 of the memory, and 19.4% smaller than xz -9e on the full Silesia corpus.

Part II — hpd: Turning HP40 into a Day-to-Day Compressor

Part I found that HP40 compresses general data 20% better than xz -9e but is unusable day to day. It runs at 8 KiB/s, commits 10.6 GiB to every file, spends most of its time waiting on DRAM, and is weak on binary records, executables and images. **hpd** is HP40-Lite rebuilt around those measurements. Every change below was profiled before it was made and measured after.

Results.

	GP set (42 files, 27 MB)	full Silesia (212 MB)	speed, 1 thread, same machine*	peak RAM
hpd	**1.823 bpc** (−21.3% vs xz -9e)	**1.474 bpc** (−19.4% vs xz -9e)	**78.6 KiB/s**	0.6 GiB (1 thread)
HP40, `--mem 22`	1.851 bpc (−20.1%)	not run	14.2 KiB/s	10.6 GiB
HP40-Lite, `--mem 22`	1.874 bpc (−19.1%)	not run	30.3 KiB/s	6.2 GiB
xz -9e	2.316 bpc	1.829 bpc	1,924 KiB/s	76 MiB

*enwik8 1 MiB + Silesia ooffice + Calgary book1, one job alone on the VM (Table 5).

hpd is **1.55% smaller than HP40 and 2.7% smaller than HP40-Lite**, while running **5.6× faster than HP40 and 2.6× faster than Lite** in **1/18 of HP40's memory**. It writes the smallest archive of all tested compressors on 40 of 41 distinct GP files and on all 12 full Silesia files. The one GP loss is a 13 KB English paper, where brotli's built-in dictionary wins by 38 bytes. The x86, record-structured and image files where HP40 was weakest are now its largest wins. On text it remains 0–1.8% behind full HP40. Every archive in every run decoded byte-exactly.

hpd also runs on an NVIDIA GPU (§19). The GPU build writes archives byte-identical to the CPU build, but an RTX 3090 only reaches 0.84–0.95× the speed of the 64-thread CPU it was tested against. It also needs shards of 16–64 KiB, which make archives 27–45% larger. On this model the CPU is the better place to run.

10. Method

- **Base.** HP40-Lite's 134 compile switches were resolved with `unifdef` (3,977 lines, no `#if` left). The stripped tree writes byte-identical archives to the HP40-Lite binary (checked on three files).
- **One change at a time.** Each change was built as its own binary and measured on the 13-file tuning set from Part I (ratio, single thread, 4 jobs in parallel) and for speed on enwik8 1 MiB + Silesia `ooffice` run alone, with a full round trip. Changes that should not alter the output (*exact*) were checked byte-for-byte.
- **Final evaluation.** The same 42-file GP set as Part I, single thread, one job alone on the machine; then the full 212 MB Silesia corpus with 4 threads, the way a user would run it; then clean single-job timings of HP40, Lite and hpd on the same three files on the same machine (the VM was replaced mid-study by a faster one, so Part I's timings are not directly comparable to hpd's).

11. Speed: removing the DRAM wait

Part I's profile put 95% of `ContextModel::predict` on one load, `t_[idx_]`: one random DRAM access per context model per bit, about 30 per bit. The fix is the classic one from paq8/lpaq, adapted to HP's two-output models:

- **Bucketed tables.** Each context gets one 32-byte bucket per *nibble*: a 16-bit checksum and 15 bit-history slots, one per node of the nibble's binary tree. Two buckets share a 64-byte cache line as a 2-way set; on a miss the bucket whose first-bit history has seen fewer bits is replaced. A model now touches 2 cache lines per byte instead of 8 random slots.

- **Prefetch.** Each model computes its bucket address when its context is set (byte boundary) and again right after bit 3. Every model issues its load before any model predicts, so ~16 loads overlap instead of queueing.
- **Checksums.** HP40 had none, so unrelated contexts shared statistics. This is why HP40 always wanted bigger tables (Part I: kennedy.xls was 22% worse at `--mem 16`). With checksums, ratio *improved* by 0.72%.

After bucketing, `ContextModel::predict` fell from 35% of CPU to about 3%, and the profile became compute-bound. The next items were exact arithmetic fixes:

step	what	output	speed
1	bucketed, checksummed, prefetched tables	−0.72% (tuning set)	×1.6 – 1.9
2	`log2_q16`: 4,097-entry table instead of a 16-step squaring loop (called ~15× per bit by the Hedge layer, discovery-pool MDL and GRIA)	*exact*	×1.57
3	Pitman–Yor estimate: 13×13 table + reciprocal multiply instead of two 64-bit divides (verified on all 692,224 inputs)	*exact*	×1.18
4	mixer: AVX2 64-bit dot product, 32-bit update (provably no overflow at lr ≤ 4)	*exact*	×1.02
5	per-model growth cap (`-g 2`, see §12)	+0.03%	×1.14

Steps 1–5 together: **×3–3.5 single-thread** at equal table size (enwik8 + ooffice at `--mem 18`: 24.9 → 73.4 KiB/s). After step 4 the profile is flat; no line is above ~5%. The remaining cost is the work itself: 11 layer-1 mixers × 52 inputs, ~20 bucketed context models and their state-map updates. Further speed must come from doing less, or from more cores.

12. Memory and start-up

change	effect
demand-zero tables (`mmap` / `VirtualAlloc`) instead of value-initialised `std::vector`	start-up 17–36 s → ~0; untouched table pages cost nothing
one shared match history instead of 11 private copies	−10 history buffers
growth cap `-g 2`: a model's table may grow at most 2 bits above the base (HP40 let word tables grow 9 bits, to 2^{31} slots)	RSS on 1 MiB: 1.92 GiB → 0.54 GiB, +0.03% size
auto table size: base table ≈ 4× the block	small files get small tables; ratio equal to `--mem 22` within 0.15%

Demand-zero alone does not solve memory: random touches into a 4 GiB table dirty most of its pages even on a 1 MiB input. The cap is what bounds RSS.

13. Ratio: models for data HP40 never saw

Part I's weakest files were binary records (`sao`, `kennedy.xls`, `osdb`), executables (`ooffice`) and a fax bitmap (`pic`, where xz won). The expert-mining had shown that HP40 adapts to such data only through its discovery pool. hpd adds explicit models instead:

change	tuning set	headline file	speed
record model: detects a fixed record length online (a byte recurring at the same distance 4× running votes for that period; a period is adopted after 16 votes) and adds 3 bucketed contexts: above+above², above+left, column+above	**−2.24%**	kennedy.xls −40%, sao −11%	−4%
mixer weight set selected by relative position inside the record	−0.26%	sao −1.6% more	−3%
word-bigram model restored (Lite had dropped it; affordable now)	−0.14%	dickens −0.7%	−3%
x86 CALL transform: E8 operands in $\pm 2^{24}$ rotated by position mod 2^{25} (a bijection), on blocks whose call targets repeat	—	ooffice **−14.0%**	—

change	tuning set	headline file	speed
stored blocks; stop modelling data that has expanded for 1 MiB	random data: input + 30 B	—	—

Measured and **rejected** (not worth their cost):

tried	result
12 discovery slots instead of 4	−0.40%, −23% speed → kept as `-9`, not default
2-D raster context on the record model	−0.03%
4th APM on a hashed order-2 / order-3 context	−0.04% / 0.00%
fewer discovery slots (1–2) as a fast mode	+0.2%, only +7% speed

14. Results on the GP set (42 files, single thread)

Table 4. GP set, archive bytes (bits per byte), single thread.

compressor	Calgary	Canterbury	Silesia-1M	enwik8.8mb	**total**	vs xz -9e
hpd	**694,158** (1.708)	**355,495** (1.012)	**3,374,326** (2.145)	1,735,211 (1.655)	**6,159,190 (1.823)**	**−21.3%**
HP40 (mem 22)	697,974 (1.717)	364,487 (1.037)	3,472,235 (2.208)	**1,721,462** (1.642)	6,256,158 (1.851)	−20.1%
HP40-Lite (mem 22)	704,110 (1.732)	372,811 (1.061)	3,514,543 (2.234)	1,740,566 (1.660)	6,332,030 (1.874)	−19.1%
xz -9e	883,752 (2.174)	493,080 (1.403)	4,147,436 (2.637)	2,303,468 (2.197)	7,827,736 (2.316)	0
brotli -q11 -w24	856,672 (2.108)	490,662 (1.397)	4,199,624 (2.670)	2,288,519 (2.183)	7,835,477 (2.319)	+0.1%

hpd's run: 5.0 min to compress and 5.0 min to decompress the 27 MB (87.5 KiB/s), peak 650 MiB, 42/42 byte-exact round trips (`data/gp_hpd_t1.jsonl`).

Table 5. Single-job timings on one machine (enwik8 1 MiB + ooffice + book1 = 2,865,923 bytes; `data/clean_timing_v2.jsonl`).

compressor	bpc (3 files)	compress	decompress	KiB/s	compress time vs hpd	peak RSS	round trip
hpd	2.148	35.6 s	36.4 s	78.6	×1.0	599 MiB	3/3 exact
HP40, mem 22	2.296	197.7 s	171.3 s	14.2	×5.6	10.6 GiB	3/3 exact
HP40-Lite, mem 22	2.326	92.4 s	95.3 s	30.3	×2.6	6.2 GiB	3/3 exact
HP40, mem 18	2.351	114.8 s	113.1 s	24.4	×3.2	690 MiB	3/3 exact
HP40-Lite, mem 18	2.391	69.4 s	70.2 s	40.3	×2.0	404 MiB	3/3 exact
xz -9e	2.918	1.5 s	0.1 s	1923.5	1/24	76 MiB	3/3 exact
brotli -q11 -w24	2.897	6.6 s	0.0 s	421.9	1/5	31 MiB	3/3 exact
zstd –ultra -22 –long	3.029	2.3 s	0.0 s	1208.1	1/15	653 MiB	3/3 exact
bzip2 -9	2.919	0.3 s	0.2 s	10489.5	1/133	17 MiB	3/3 exact
gzip -9	3.531	0.3 s	0.0 s	10321.7	1/131	17 MiB	3/3 exact

- **Against HP40** hpd is smaller on 8 of 41 files, all binary: kennedy.xls −25.2%, ooffice −13.6%, pic −13.1%, sao −8.8%, geo −0.8%, x-ray −0.2%, mr and book1 equal. It is larger on the other 33, all by +0.1% to +1.8% (worst: reymont +1.8%, obj1 +1.5%, osdb/nci/trans/progp +1.2%). These are text and source, where HP40-Lite dropped experts. The binary wins outweigh the text losses: −1.55% overall.
- **Against the general-purpose tools** hpd is 8% (pic, vs xz) to 72% (kennedy.xls) smaller, except Calgary `paper4` (brotli 4,283 B, hpd 4,321 B).
- **Against HP40-Lite**, the base it was built from, hpd is smaller overall by 2.7%. On text it ranges from −1.1% (dickens) to +0.4% (paper5, cp.html): the restored word-bigram model and the checksums help the larger texts, and the smaller tables cost a little on the smallest files.

15. Full Silesia, 4 threads

Table 6. Full Silesia corpus, `hpd c` with 4 threads (auto blocks: files over 16 MiB split into 16 MiB+ blocks). Baselines from Part I (single thread; measured on the earlier VM alongside other jobs, so their times are only indicative). Bold = smallest.

file	bytes	hpd -t 4	xz -9e	brotli -q11 -w24	zstd -19 –long	bzip2 -9	gzip -9	hpd vs xz	hpd time (c / d)
dickens	10,192,446	**2,160,385**	2,831,212	2,827,777	2,849,699	2,799,520	3,851,815	-23.7%	112 s / 111 s
mozilla	51,220,480	**11,758,188**	13,376,240	13,872,265	15,039,972	17,914,392	18,994,134	-12.1%	220 s / 193 s
mr	9,970,564	**2,191,161**	2,751,892	2,823,136	3,112,762	2,441,280	3,673,937	-20.4%	93 s / 93 s

file	bytes	hpd -t 4	xz -9e	brotli -q11 -w24	zstd -19 –long	bzip2 -9	gzip -9	hpd vs xz	hpd time (c / d)
nci	33,553,445	**1,186,824**	1,449,272	1,519,768	1,641,522	1,812,734	2,987,529	-18.1%	134 s / 136 s
ooffice	6,152,192	**1,700,557**	2,427,224	2,478,855	2,598,815	2,862,526	3,090,434	-29.9%	74 s / 76 s
osdb	10,085,684	**2,219,794**	2,844,556	2,816,278	3,098,462	2,802,792	3,716,337	-22.0%	109 s / 109 s
reymont	6,627,202	**985,787**	1,315,592	1,332,158	1,347,631	1,246,230	1,820,826	-25.1%	66 s / 68 s
samba	21,606,400	**3,001,943**	3,739,524	3,766,340	3,892,270	4,549,759	5,408,266	-19.7%	171 s / 170 s
sao	7,251,944	**3,806,352**	4,425,664	4,586,092	5,000,512	4,940,524	5,327,037	-14.0%	93 s / 94 s
webster	41,458,703	**6,038,618**	8,368,672	8,428,575	8,624,454	8,644,714	12,061,616	-27.8%	179 s / 180 s
x-ray	8,474,240	**3,688,727**	4,491,264	4,682,753	5,155,749	4,051,112	6,037,707	-17.9%	99 s / 100 s
xml	5,345,280	**309,016**	434,892	430,566	454,679	441,186	662,280	-28.9%	47 s / 47 s
total	**211,938,580**	**39,047,352**	**48,456,004**	**49,564,563**	**52,816,527**	**54,506,769**	**67,631,918**	**-19.4%**	23.3 / 22.9 min
bits per byte		1.474	1.829	1.871	1.994	2.057	2.553		
compress / decompress		23.3 min / 22.9 min	3.5 min / 0.1 min	11.5 min / 0.0 min	3.0 min / 0.0 min	24 s / 13.1 s	24 s / 1.9 s		
peak RSS		2455 MiB	506 MiB	238 MiB	141 MiB	18 MiB	18 MiB		

hpd: 148 KiB/s compress and 150 KiB/s decompress over the whole corpus with 4 threads; the large files (mozilla, nci, samba, webster) ran 2–4 blocks in parallel, the rest one block on one thread. Peak RAM 2.4 GiB (four 16 MiB blocks' models at once). All 12 files decoded byte-exactly (`data/silfull_hpd_t4.jsonl`).

No other context-mixing compressor (paq8px, cmix) was run, so hpd's place among CM compressors is not measured here.

16. Portability

- The codec has no floating point; archives are identical bytes on Linux (GCC 13, `-march=native`) and Windows (MinGW-w64 GCC, `-mavx2`), and each platform decodes the other's archives (Windows binary tested under Wine 9).
- Large files: sizes come from `std::filesystem`, blocks are streamed, so >2 GiB inputs work on Windows. Memory is bounded by threads × (block + tables), not by file size.
- MSVC is not tested.

17. What is still weak

- **Speed.** ~80–90 KiB/s per thread to compress *and* decompress. That is 5.6× HP40, but still about 24× slower than xz -9e to compress and several thousand times slower to decompress (Table 5). Files under 16 MiB are one block on one thread. Day to day this means a 10 MB document takes about 2 minutes each way.
- **Text vs HP40.** hpd is 0.0–1.8% larger than full HP40 on text (Lite's missing word/sentence experts; −1.55% overall only because of the binary wins). Restoring HP40's text experts, now affordable, is the obvious next step.
- **No partial-stream bypass** in the measured build. A tar with a few compressed members still models those members bit by bit; only whole blocks fall back to stored. *Fixed in hpd 1.0.0 (§18):* 64 KiB chunks of incompressible data inside a block are copied unmodelled.
- **One file in, one file out.** No directory archiving. *hpd 1.0.0 adds stdin/stdout*, so `tar cf - dir | hpd c - -` covers directories.

18. Source code

The complete hpd source is packaged as `dist/hpd-1.2.0-src.zip` (366,030 bytes, 41 files, SHA-256 `7e11febcd342c077769d92dfb95`
It holds `src/`, `include/hp/`, the Makefile, the README with the archive format, the round-trip, fuzz and GPU-vs-CPU tests, the GPU build (`src/hpd_gpu.cuh`, `make gpu`, §19) with its plan and measurements (`GPU_PLAN.md`), the benchmark runners and the AGPL-3.0 licence. To build and test:

```
unzip hpd-1.2.0-src.zip && cd hpd-1.2.0
make && make test            # needs a C++20 compiler (GCC 13 tested)
build/hpd c FILE && build/hpd t FILE.hpd
```

The zip is built from the git tree by `compress/hpd/tools/make_src_zip.py` (fixed timestamps, LF line endings, entries stored uncompressed), so the same tree gives the same bytes on any platform and the hash above can be re-checked.

Version measured vs. version packaged. The numbers in §§11–16 were measured with the archive-format-2 build. hpd 1.0.0 keeps the same model and changes only the container and the tooling: a CRC-32 per block and per stream, a streaming end marker, pass-through of incompressible 64 KiB chunks, `t/l` commands, stdin/stdout, and decoder limit checks. On files with no passed-through chunks its archives are exactly 7 bytes larger for a single-block file (5 bytes per block, 2 per archive), checked on this paper's text, the hpd binary and a PNG figure. hpd 1.0.0 still decodes format-2

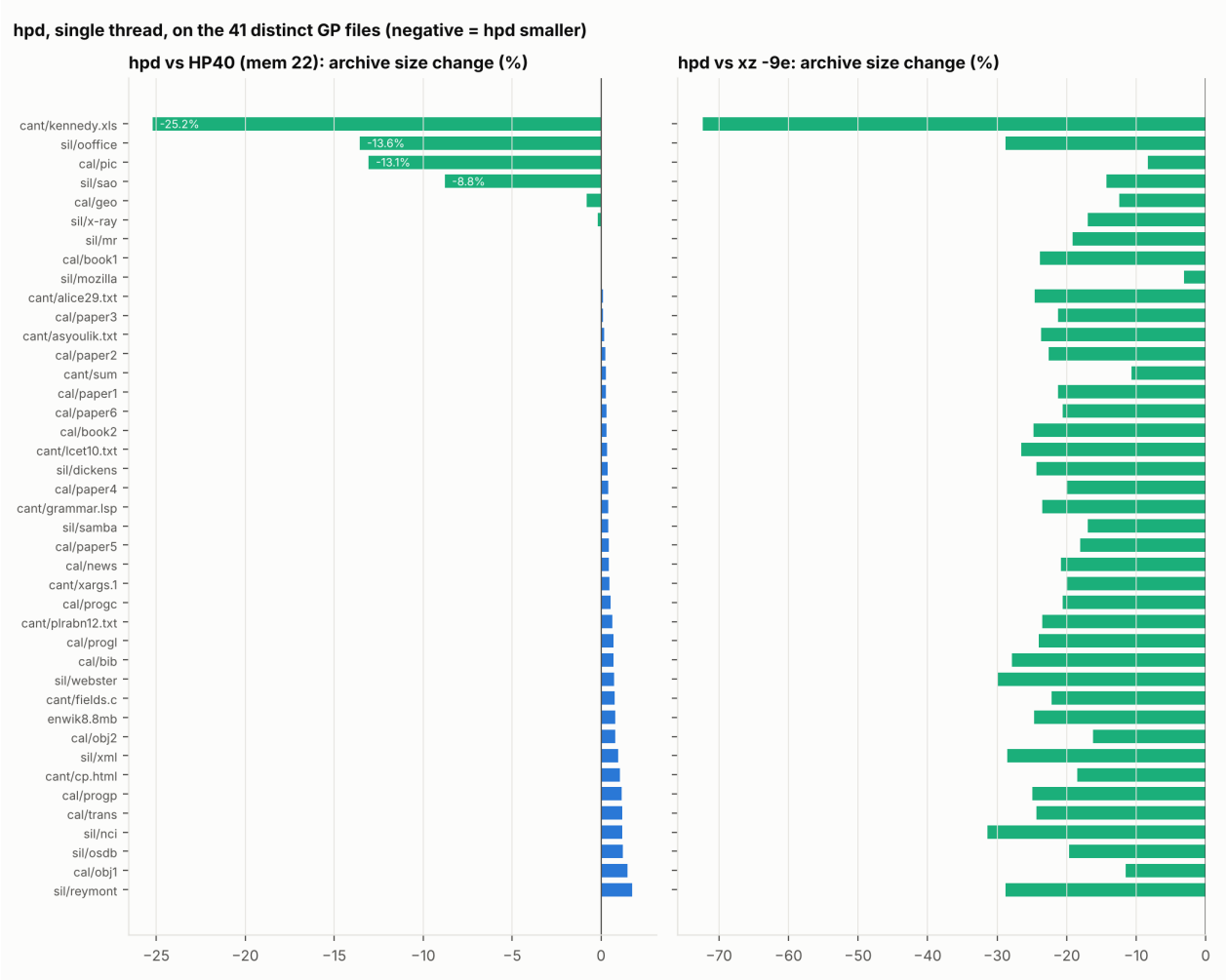


Figure 12. hpd against HP40 (left) and xz -9e (right), per file. Negative = hpd smaller.

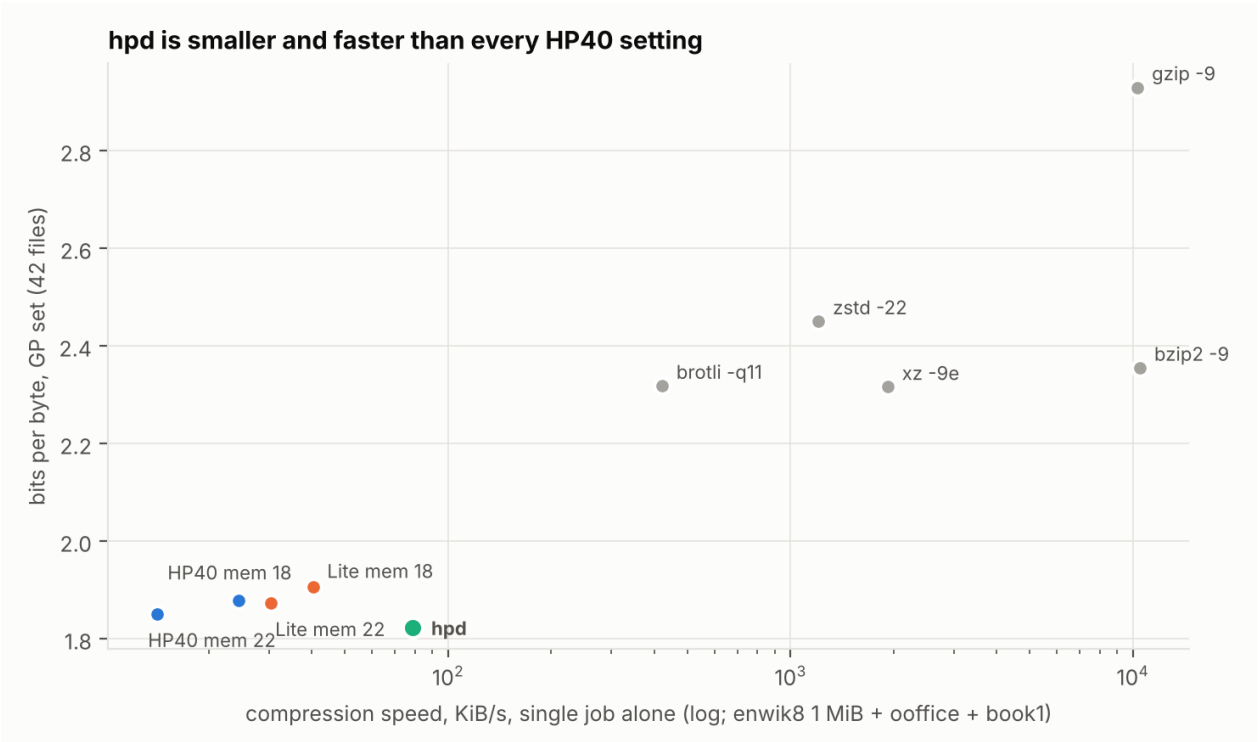


Figure 13. Ratio (GP set) against single-job compression speed (same machine, same three files).

archives. hpd 1.1.0 adds the GPU build (§19) and 1.2.0 its warp-per-shard kernels; their CPU build writes the same bytes as 1.0.0. Its decoder passed 2,000 mutated archives from `test/fuzz.sh` with no crash and no wrong output.

19. On the GPU

hpd now also builds as **hpd-gpu** (`make gpu`, `hpd c -G`). One GPU thread codes one shard with the unchanged model, compiled for the GPU with clang's `force_cuda_host_device` pragma; the CPU does the CRC, x86 transform, pass-through chunks and container. The GPU archive is **byte-identical** to the CPU archive with the same settings, and each build decodes the other's (checked on 4,096 shards of a 64 MiB test bed and by `test/gpu_check.sh`). Measured on an RTX 3090 (24 GB) against the 64-thread Xeon Gold 6242 in the same machine. Test bed: the first 16 MiB of Silesia webster, mozilla, nci and samba.

What sharding costs. Every GPU thread needs its own shard, and each shard starts learning from nothing:

shards	shard size	archive bytes	bits/byte	vs 16 MiB shards	vs xz -9e
4	16 MiB	11,029,625	1.315	0	−17.4%
16	4 MiB	11,335,708	1.351	+2.8%	−15.1%
64	1 MiB	11,889,096	1.417	+7.8%	−10.9%
256	256 KiB	12,749,391	1.520	+15.6%	−4.5%
1,024	64 KiB (`-M 18`)	13,984,756	1.667	+26.8%	+4.8%
4,096	16 KiB (`-M 18`)	15,970,901	1.904	+44.8%	+19.6%

xz -9e on the same 64 MiB: 13,349,436 bytes (1.591 bits/byte).

Speed. Two GPU layouts, 64 MiB test bed, table bits 16:

	thread per shard	warp per shard (default)	CPU, 64 threads
16 KiB shards, compress	575 KiB/s	940 KiB/s	1,069 KiB/s
16 KiB shards, decompress	573 KiB/s	899 KiB/s	1,068 KiB/s
64 KiB shards, compress	—	1,091 KiB/s	1,153 KiB/s
64 KiB shards, decompress	—	1,078 KiB/s	1,194 KiB/s

With one thread per shard the GPU is about **2× slower** than the CPU: even the smallest model needs 19.3 MB per shard, so the card holds only 1,134 shards, and one GPU thread runs the whole model at about 2 KiB/s. With **one warp per shard** the 32 lanes share each bit's work: every context model and match model on its own lane, the mixer's dot products and updates split over all lanes with exact integer reductions, lane 0 for the short serial parts. One shard then runs at 5.7 KiB/s, and the card reaches **0.84–0.95× the CPU**, with identical bytes. It does not pass the CPU because it is issue-bound with mostly idle lanes (different lanes run different model code, and lane 0's serial parts take about 30% of the time), not bandwidth-bound (memory controller 34% busy). Shards small enough to fill the card also cost 27–45% in ratio and fall behind xz -9e.

Next. A GPU win would need 32 shards per warp in lock-step with tens of thousands of shards resident, so per-shard state near 0.7 MB instead of 19 MB: a smaller model with its own archive bytes. Until then the CPU build is as fast and keeps large shards. Plan, profile and raw measurements: `compress/hpd/GPU_PLAN.md` §9.

20. Conclusion

The profile in Part I said HP40 was slow because it waited on DRAM, large because it zeroed and never capped its tables, and weak where it had no model for the data. Fixing exactly those three things gave hpd: 5.6× faster than HP40 in 1/18 of its memory, and 1.55% smaller as well, because the bucketed tables, the record model and the x86 transform add ratio as well as speed. Against general-purpose compressors it writes the smallest archive on 40 of 41 GP files and all 12 Silesia files, 21.3% and 19.4% smaller than xz -9e.

Its cost is speed: about 80 KiB/s per thread in both directions, so it suits archives and backups rather than data read back often. Moving the model to a GPU does not change that. A byte-identical GPU build works, and a warp per shard brings an RTX 3090 level with a 64-thread CPU, but no further. The model's per-shard state (19 MB) caps how many shards the card can hold, and its branchy, serial integer code leaves most lanes idle. The remaining gains are on the CPU side: HP40's text experts, which hpd still lacks (0–1.8% on text), and faster model code. A GPU build that beats the CPU would need a much smaller model, which would write different archives.

Appendices

Appendix A. Reproducing Part I

```
# 1. binaries (clones CompressionAlgorithm @ 0b1ced2, applies the switch patch)
paper/hp40/scripts/build.sh /tmp/hp40build
# 2. anchor: must print 1721462
/tmp/hp40build/hp_v40 c --mem 22 enwik8.8mb out.hp && stat -c %s out.hp
# 3. one benchmark row: compress, decompress, verify (binaries from $HP_BIN)
HP_BIN=/tmp/hp40build python3 paper/hp40/scripts/bench.py hp40_m18 rows.jsonl FILE...
# 4. expert mining for one file, then the summary
/tmp/hp40build/mine_v40 FILE out/v40_NAME 18 29 300000 65536
python3 paper/hp40/scripts/analyze_mine.py v40 mine_v40.json out/v40_NAME
# 5. every table and figure in this paper from data/
python3 paper/hp40/scripts/gen_tables.py && python3 paper/hp40/scripts/make_figures.py
```

Corpora: enwik8 (mattmahoney.net / data.deepai.org mirror), Canterbury (corpus.canterbury.ac.nz), the large Calgary corpus (data-compression.info), Silesia (sun.aei.polsl.pl). `enwik8.8mb` is `head -c 8388608 enwik8` (SHA-256 `09f6dd72…ee8e`); Silesia-1M is `head -c 1048576` of each Silesia file; the tuning set is `tail -c +4194305 FILE | head -c 262144` per Silesia file plus `tail -c +60000001 enwik8 | head -c 524288`.

Data files

file	contents
`data/v40_flags.txt`, `data/lite_flags.txt`, `data/lite_L*.txt`	compile recipes
`data/gp_*.jsonl`, `data/base_gp.jsonl`, `data/base_silfull.jsonl`	every benchmark row: sizes, wall/user/sys, peak RSS, round-trip
`data/clean_timing.jsonl`	single-job timings (Table 3)
`data/abl_m18.jsonl`, `data/addback_m18.jsonl`, `data/ablation_summary.*`, `data/kennedy_m18.jsonl`	Lite search
`data/mine_v40.json`, `data/mine_lite.json`, `data/corr_v40_*.json`	expert mining summaries and correlation matrices
`data/*_ni_*.json`, `data/first_touch.txt`, `data/startup*.jsonl`	CPU profile shares, page-zeroing and start-up measurements
`data/tables.md`, `data/gp_summary.json`	generated tables

Appendix B. Per-file archive bytes

Bold marks the smallest archive in the row. `pic` and `ptt5` are the same file.

file	bytes	HP40 (mem 22)	HP40-Lite (mem 22)	xz -9e	brotli -q11 -w24	bzip2 -9	zstd –ultra -22 –long	HP40 vs xz
cal/bib	111,261	**21,913**	22,052	30,604	28,380	27,467	31,925	-28.4%
cal/book1	768,771	**198,989**	200,155	261,376	256,323	232,598	264,373	-23.9%
cal/book2	610,856	**127,370**	128,857	169,864	165,262	157,443	173,860	-25.0%
cal/geo	102,400	**46,938**	47,439	53,168	52,915	56,921	64,713	-11.7%
cal/news	377,109	**93,718**	94,348	118,908	112,968	118,600	122,694	-21.2%
cal/obj1	21,504	**8,245**	8,381	9,456	9,341	10,787	9,859	-12.8%
cal/obj2	246,814	**51,067**	52,632	61,456	65,203	76,441	70,288	-16.9%
cal/paper1	53,161	**13,591**	13,638	17,292	15,457	16,558	17,590	-21.4%
cal/paper2	82,199	**21,064**	21,157	27,264	24,850	25,041	27,553	-22.7%
cal/paper3	46,526	**13,454**	13,457	17,096	14,639	15,837	17,173	-21.3%
cal/paper4	13,286	4,304	4,309	5,408	**4,283**	5,188	5,370	-20.4%
cal/paper5	11,954	**4,000**	4,003	4,904	4,073	4,837	4,865	-18.4%
cal/paper6	38,105	**9,917**	9,962	12,516	11,135	12,292	12,727	-20.8%
cal/pic	513,216	42,014	41,932	**39,860**	40,939	49,759	43,442	+5.4%
cal/progc	39,611	**9,939**	9,985	12,572	11,619	12,544	12,797	-20.9%
cal/progl	71,646	**11,293**	11,379	14,968	14,003	15,579	15,149	-24.6%
cal/progp	49,379	**7,683**	7,783	10,348	9,880	10,710	10,450	-25.8%
cal/trans	93,695	**12,475**	12,641	16,692	15,402	17,899	17,295	-25.3%
cant/alice29.txt	152,089	**36,535**	36,799	48,528	46,487	43,202	49,212	-24.7%
cant/asyoulik.txt	125,179	**33,991**	34,092	44,592	42,712	39,569	45,138	-23.8%
cant/cp.html	24,603	**6,170**	6,213	7,652	6,894	7,624	7,716	-19.4%
cant/fields.c	11,150	**2,341**	2,354	3,032	2,717	3,039	3,017	-22.8%
cant/grammar.lsp	3,721	**984**	986	1,292	1,124	1,283	1,213	-23.8%
cant/kennedy.xls	1,029,744	**19,214**	24,730	51,868	61,498	130,280	69,726	-63.0%

file	bytes	HP40 (mem 22)	HP40-Lite (mem 22)	xz -9e	brotli -q11 -w24	bzip2 -9	zstd –ultra -22 –long	HP40 vs xz
cant/lcet10.txt	426,754	**87,520**	88,497	119,488	113,416	107,706	121,371	-26.8%
cant/plrabn12.txt	481,861	**125,808**	126,916	165,456	163,267	145,577	167,439	-24.0%
cant/ptt5	513,216	42,014	41,932	**39,860**	40,939	49,759	43,442	+5.4%
cant/sum	38,240	**8,468**	8,848	9,500	10,144	12,909	11,077	-10.9%
cant/xargs.1	4,227	**1,442**	1,444	1,812	1,464	1,762	1,729	-20.4%
enwik/enwik8.8mb	8,388,608	**1,721,462**	1,740,566	2,303,468	2,288,519	2,448,077	2,365,633	-25.3%
sil/dickens	1,048,576	**233,716**	237,147	310,240	305,265	285,604	313,520	-24.7%
sil/mozilla	1,048,576	**621,732**	623,305	641,444	635,440	664,085	640,419	-3.1%
sil/mr	1,048,576	214,050	**213,722**	264,592	271,989	229,405	312,602	-19.1%
sil/nci	1,048,576	**43,792**	44,309	64,580	65,459	64,824	70,656	-32.2%
sil/ooffice	1,048,576	**396,536**	404,639	481,080	488,479	518,883	508,174	-17.6%
sil/osdb	1,048,576	**249,357**	255,177	314,072	312,387	300,815	343,457	-20.6%
sil/reymont	1,048,576	**158,639**	162,018	226,704	228,207	196,068	231,536	-30.0%
sil/samba	1,048,576	**238,598**	240,902	288,656	282,533	309,227	297,024	-17.3%
sil/sao	1,048,576	**610,920**	624,834	650,276	674,615	717,160	732,078	-6.1%
sil/webster	1,048,576	**171,846**	173,418	246,792	239,314	221,791	250,051	-30.4%
sil/x-ray	1,048,576	**446,650**	447,325	536,956	576,209	487,012	649,058	-16.8%
sil/xml	1,048,576	**86,399**	87,747	122,044	119,727	108,056	124,821	-29.2%